Data Classification and Governance Policy

Meridian Capital

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Owning Team: Enterprise Data Office (EDO) | Co-stewards: Security Governance & Assurance (SG&A), Legal & Compliance (L&C), Privacy Office (PO)

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1. Policy Overview and Purpose

This Data Classification and Governance Policy establishes the enterprise standard for classifying, labeling, and governing data assets across Meridian Capital. It defines consistent taxonomies, stakeholder accountabilities, and oversight mechanisms necessary to ensure that data is handled in accordance with legal, regulatory, contractual, and internal control requirements. The policy is a pillar of Meridian Capital's Information Governance Framework and directly supports enterprise objectives for risk reduction, regulatory compliance, operational efficiency, and data enablement. The policy supersedes MC-EDO-DCG-001 v3.1 (effective 2025-06-30), incorporating enhancements derived from quarterly operational reviews, Internal Audit IA-25-317 follow-ups, and the Data Stewardship Council (DSC) workplan item DSC-2026-Q2-07.

The scope and intent of this policy are deliberately comprehensive: to make data classification a default characteristic of all enterprise data assets; to embed stewardship and accountability within business domains; and to ensure that classification decisions are verifiable, consistently applied, and measurable. The policy leverages a unified classification framework, integrating legal and regulatory obligations (e.g., GLBA, SOX, GDPR, CCPA) with Meridian Capital's risk appetite, control environment, and client commitments.

2. Scope and Applicability

This policy applies enterprise-wide to all data assets created, received, processed, transmitted, accessed, or retained by Meridian Capital, including structured datasets, unstructured documents, semi-structured files, logs, models, derived datasets, and reference/master data. Applicability extends to data in all states (in motion, at rest, and in use) and across all hosting models, including on-premises data centers, managed services, and public cloud platforms under Technology Operations (TechOps) and Cloud Platform Services (CPS) oversight. The policy covers all business units, subsidiaries, and controlled joint ventures where Meridian Capital has operational control, as well as contractors and service providers handling Meridian Capital data under contractual arrangements managed by Strategic Sourcing and third-party risk management (TPRM).

The policy interfaces with--but does not duplicate--the Corporate Records Management Standard (MC-RIM-STD-002), the Privacy and Data Protection Policy (MC-PO-PDP-004), and the Information Risk Management Standard (MC-R&C-IRM-006). Where there is overlap, the most stringent applicable requirement prevails. This policy is published as "Internal Use Only" and is accessible via the Governance Repository (Confluence DOC-019283) to all authorized employees and contractors.

3. Policy Statement and Objectives

Meridian Capital requires that all enterprise data assets are classified using the standard classification taxonomy at the point of creation or acquisition and that the assigned classification is maintained as the asset evolves through its lifecycle. Classification shall be discernible, consistently applied across systems and processes, and retrievable for reporting, audit, and regulatory inquiries. The objectives of this policy are to: establish a single enterprise classification

framework with clear definitions; delineate roles and responsibilities for data owners, stewards, custodians, and users; embed classification metadata within enterprise data catalogs and lineage tooling; and enable monitoring using standardized metrics and thresholds.

Outcomes are measured through key performance indicators (KPIs) reported quarterly to the DGC. Baseline metrics as of Q2 FY26 (report GSM-2026-Q2-DCG, issued 2026-06-20T10:18:54Z) indicate: 93.4% of registered data assets carry an approved classification; median time-to-classify for new assets is 6.2 business days against a 10-business-day internal target; 98.1% of stewarded domains met the quarterly review cadence; and 147 classification-related tickets remain open beyond 30 days (ServiceNow queue EDO-CLASS), trending down 12% quarter-over-quarter. These metrics inform prioritization, resourcing, and continuous improvement actions coordinated by the EDO.

4. Governance Model and Oversight

The Data Governance Council (DGC), chaired by the CDO and comprising senior representatives from Risk & Controls (R&C), SG&A, L&C, PO, TechOps, and major business lines, provides policy oversight and approves enterprise-wide changes. The Council meets monthly (standard calendar: second Wednesday, 15:00-16:30 ET) with minutes recorded under DGC Minute References and archived in DOC-010212. The Data Stewardship Council (DSC) operates as a practitioner forum, convened bi-weekly to resolve classification ambiguities, harmonize domain-specific taxonomies, and manage the steward workplan. Decisions of the DSC are recorded in Jira (component: Data Governance) and escalated to the DGC when policy interpretation or cross-domain alignment is required.

The Enterprise Data Office acts as policy owner and custodian of the classification taxonomy, coordinating inputs from business data owners, domain stewards, SG&A, and the Privacy Office. SG&A ensures alignment with enterprise control standards and provides independent assurance through control design reviews and thematic assessments. L&C and the Privacy Office interpret regulatory and contractual drivers, advising on jurisdictional nuances and client obligations. TechOps and CPS ensure classification metadata can be discovered and reported through enterprise tooling, including the data catalog, lineage, and observability platforms. Internal Audit performs periodic reviews on design and operating effectiveness, with current observations tracked under IA-26-071-DCG and managed via EDO remediation tickets (EDO-REM-320 through EDO-REM-339).

5. Definitions (Selected)

For purposes of this policy, a data asset is any collection of data elements managed as a unit, including datasets, documents, reports, dashboards, and analytical models with embedded data. A data owner is the accountable executive within a business domain who authorizes classification decisions and accepts residual risk. A data steward is the appointed subject matter expert responsible for maintaining classification accuracy and metadata quality for assigned assets. A data custodian is the technology function responsible for hosting, storing, transmitting, or integrating data assets while honoring assigned classification. A data user is any individual with authorized access to a data asset for business purposes. The classification taxonomy (Section 7) establishes the standardized labels adopted enterprise-wide.

Record of Revisions

- v3.2 (2026-07-01): Updated taxonomy definitions for cross-border data elements; refined KPI set; incorporated DGC decisions through minute ref DGC-2026-05-10-03; addressed Internal Audit observation IA-25-317-Obs2 on stewardship coverage. Change authorized under CHG0054832.
- v3.1 (2025-07-01): Introduced lineage integration requirements; established DSC charter; initial KPI baseline. Change authorized under CHG0049210.
- v3.0 (2024-07-01): Major refresh aligning with Information Governance Framework v2.0. Change authorized under CHG0041127.

6. Classification Framework Overview

Meridian Capital adopts a four-level classification framework designed to be intuitive, consistently applicable, and interoperable with regulatory regimes and client commitments. The levels are: Public, Internal, Confidential, and Restricted. Public denotes data approved for broad dissemination without limiting conditions (e.g., published research summaries and corporate press releases). Internal covers routine business data intended for Meridian Capital personnel and authorized contractors, where distribution is controlled by business need. Confidential encompasses data where unauthorized disclosure could cause material harm to clients, employees, operations, or partners, including, for example, non-public financial results prior to issuance, non-public client contact details, and proprietary methodologies. Restricted applies to highly sensitive data subject to explicit legal, regulatory, contractual, or fiduciary obligations, including personal data under privacy laws, select customer financial data subject to sector regulations, and other data where loss or misuse could significantly impact clients or the firm.

The taxonomy includes auxiliary attributes to express contextual dimensions needed for compliant handling. These attributes include jurisdictional tags to signal geographic legal applicability, data subject categories (e.g., client, employee, counterparty), domain tags mapping to the Enterprise Data Domain Catalog, and retention class references aligned to Records Management (MC-RIM-STD-002). Standardized definitions are maintained by the EDO and periodically reviewed by the DSC to ensure that domain-specific examples remain current with evolving business activities and legal interpretations. Where ambiguity arises, the DSC records deliberations in Jira (EDO-DSC board), and final clarifications are reflected in the policy glossary under controlled change.

7. Data Domains and Examples

The Enterprise Data Domain Catalog organizes data into coherent business groupings for stewardship and reporting. Current domains include, without limitation: Client & Relationship, Trading & Execution, Market Data, Risk & Quantitative Analytics, Finance & Treasury, Operations & Middle Office, Human Capital, Legal & Compliance, Technology & Platforms, and Vendor & Third-Party. Typical examples include customer onboarding documents, trade confirmations, market tick data, value-at-risk outputs, general ledger balances, reconciliations, employee records, regulatory filings, system inventory metadata, and supplier due diligence packages. Each domain maintains a stewardship roster with designated owners and alternates, documented in the Steward Registry (DOC-013477), with updates tracked via ServiceNow group EDO-STEWARDS. Domains leverage the common classification levels; however, examples and rationales are tailored within each domain to promote accurate and consistent classification decisions.

As of the Q2 FY26 stewardship attestation cycle (attestation window closed 2026-06-14T23:59:00Z), 41 domains and sub-domains submitted confirmations of taxonomy adoption and catalog completeness. Two domains (Vendor & Third-Party, Operations & Middle Office) reported minor variances related to legacy repositories pending catalog integration, with remediation plans logged under EDO-REM-332 and EDO-REM-334, targeting closure before the next quarterly cycle.

8. Lifecycle Governance

Classification persists across the data lifecycle--from creation and ingestion through usage, sharing, retention, archival, and disposition--and must remain accurate as data is enriched, transformed, or aggregated. Lifecycle governance requires that classification metadata accompanies data assets in enterprise catalogs and lineage views to enable traceability of classification decisions across systems and processes. When data assets are combined or derived, the resulting classification reflects the most sensitive component and any applicable jurisdictional or contractual constraints. The Records Management function supplies retention and disposition schedules; stewards ensure that classification attributes and retention classes referenced for each asset are coherent and that catalog entries indicate the authoritative source for retention rules.

Quarterly review cadences are enforced to validate classification accuracy and metadata completeness. Reviews are scheduled in alignment with domain operating rhythms and recorded as attestations, with evidence retained in the Governance Repository for a minimum of three years to support auditability. Sampling and thematic checks are coordinated by SG&A to detect inconsistencies or drift, with outcomes reported to the DGC through the Governance Scorecard (GSM series). Where reviews identify gaps, remediation tickets are created in ServiceNow (queue: EDO-CLASS, priority assigned per impact and exposure criteria), and target dates are set by domain owners. The EDO consolidates remediation trends into a quarterly analysis to identify systemic issues, training needs, or taxonomy clarifications.

9. Roles and Responsibilities

Data owners are accountable for the classification accuracy of assets within their domain and for ensuring that stewards have the capacity and subject matter coverage necessary to perform their duties. Owners approve classification decisions, especially in ambiguous cases or where cross-border or contractual elements arise. Data stewards maintain classification metadata, monitor domain KPIs, coordinate quarterly attestations, and propose taxonomy refinements. Custodians in TechOps and CPS ensure that classification metadata is discoverable in enterprise tooling and that reporting channels can provide timely insights to stakeholders. The Privacy Office and L&C provide advisory interpretations for regulatory and contractual matters and participate in reviews where data subject to privacy or legal constraints is implicated. SG&A performs second-line oversight, administering thematic reviews and control assessments, and advising on alignment with enterprise control frameworks. All employees and authorized contractors are responsible for adhering to the assigned classification of data they use and for reporting observed discrepancies via established channels (ServiceNow catalog item: EDO-INC-CLASS).

10. Monitoring, Metrics, and Reporting

The policy's effectiveness is measured through KPIs and key risk indicators (KRIs) maintained by the EDO and reviewed by the DGC. Core measures include percentage of cataloged assets with approved classification, time-to-classify for new assets, quarterly attestation completion rates, steward coverage ratios, and the volume and aging of classification-related tickets. KRIs track indicators such as fluctuations in Restricted data inventory, cross-border data element prevalence by jurisdiction tag, and recurring themes identified by SG&A's sampling. The Q2 FY26 Governance Scorecard (GSM-2026-Q2-DCG) recorded a 1.3 percentage point improvement in classification coverage and a 0.4-day improvement in median time-to-classify compared to the prior quarter. Two yellow-rated KRIs remained open related to cross-domain consistency in jurisdictional tagging; corrective actions are documented in EDO-REM-335 and EDO-REM-336 with target remediation dates in Q3 FY26. Reporting is delivered to the DGC monthly and to executive management quarterly, with timestamps and distribution lists maintained for audit traceability.

This policy does not authorize exceptions. Identified gaps are remediated through standard governance channels with accountability tracked to data owners and stewards, and progress monitored by the EDO and SG&A. The absence of exceptions reinforces uniformity and predictability in governance and supports Meridian Capital's commitment to consistent, high-quality data management across all domains.

Section 2. Governance Structure and Accountability

2.1 Oversight Bodies and Operating Model

Meridian Capital's Data Governance operating model is anchored by a tiered structure that establishes clear decision rights, sustained executive sponsorship, and measurable accountability across business lines and enabling functions. The Enterprise Data Governance Council (EDGC) serves as the principal authority for this policy and meets on a scheduled quarterly cadence, with extraordinary sessions convened as required by material changes in regulatory expectations or strategic programs. The EDGC is chaired by the Chief Data Officer (CDO) and includes voting members from the Institutional Markets Group, Wealth Management, Finance, Risk, Operations, Legal & Compliance, and Technology. Quorum is defined as the CDO plus a minimum of four business-aligned members and one control partner (Information Risk & Compliance or Privacy Office). The EDGC charter (Ref. DGC-CHARTER-2025 v3.2) outlines remit, membership, and standard agenda items, including policy stewardship, oversight of classification coverage metrics, and disposition of material exceptions previously authorized under legacy frameworks. No new exceptions are within scope of this policy; remediation planning and closure are overseen by the EDGC until legacy gaps are retired.

Working committees report into the EDGC to provide subject matter depth and continuous operational oversight. The Data Quality Steering Group (DQSG) prioritizes remediation of data defects that have classification implications and tracks sustained improvements via lineage-informed root cause narratives. The Privacy & Records Forum ensures that classification decisions are harmonized with records retention schedules and applicable data residency requirements. The Technology Enablement Working Group (TEWG) aligns platform capabilities for cataloging and metadata with the policy's classification needs. All committees submit monthly summaries to the EDGC Secretariat, including action items, status of open decisions, and relevant ticket references for audit traceability.

2.2 Roles and Responsibilities

Data ownership is assigned at the domain level and is held by senior business leaders (Managing Director or VP-equivalent) who are accountable for correct classification and for ensuring coverage of their domain's authoritative data sets. Data Owners approve domain-level classification standards, endorse remediation priorities, and attest annually to completeness and accuracy (see GRC-ATTEST-2026-04-15, submitted 2026-04-17T10:42:03Z). Data Stewards, designated by Data Owners, operationalize the policy within their domains, maintain catalog entries, coordinate issue remediation, and validate that metadata reflects current classification status. Data Custodians in Technology are responsible for platform-level enablement of classification metadata, ensuring that authoritative tagging is reflected consistently across integrated repositories and lineage artifacts. Control Partners, including Information Risk & Compliance (IRC), Privacy Office, Records Management, and Internal Audit, provide challenge, independent monitoring, and periodic assessments against policy requirements.

This division of responsibilities is documented in the Data Governance Responsibility Matrix (Ref. DCG-RACI-2026 v2.1), which is maintained by the Enterprise Data Governance Office (EDGO). The matrix is authoritative for audit purposes and is reviewed semi-annually to reflect organizational or system changes. Changes to role assignments are tracked via ServiceNow request items and require approvals from the originating business line, EDGO, and IRC (e.g., SNOW-RITM-00418267, approved 2026-05-29T16:58:44Z).

2.3 Operating Rhythm, Artifacts, and Documentation

The policy lifecycle is governed by the Document Management Standard and retained in the Corporate Policy Repository under identifier POL-DATA-CLASS-25.1. The annual review cycle includes a formal impact analysis, stakeholder consultation, and Executive Sponsor approval. The most recent review (Policy Review Ticket EDGO-GOV-4187) commenced 2026-03-01T09:00:00Z and closed 2026-04-12T13:21:15Z, confirming no material changes required and extending the effective period to 2027-04-30. Supporting artifacts include:

- Data Classification Assessment Worksheet (DCG-AW-2026 v1.4)
- Data Domain Inventory Register (DDIR-2026 v5.0)
- Records Retention Mapping Crosswalk (RMS-XW-2026 v3.3)
- Governance Metrics Pack (GM-Pack-Q2FY26)

All artifacts are version-controlled and referenced in meeting minutes. The EDGO maintains a unified backlog in the Governance Portfolio (JIRA project key: EDGO-GOV) to manage policy enhancements, classification disputes, and domain onboarding activities. Tickets carry standardized metadata for severity, impacted domain, and cross-functional reviewers. As of 2026-06-30, the backlog reported 63 open items, with a median age of 12.6 days and on-time closure of 91.3% against the 10-business-day service objective (Ref. GM-Pack-Q2FY26, tab "Backlog Performance").

2.4 Decision-Making and Escalation

Classification disputes that cannot be resolved at the domain level are escalated to the DQSG for adjudication. The DQSG applies the criteria set forth in Section 3 and records rationale in the Classification Decision Log with supporting evidence from the catalog and domain documentation. Decisions requiring a change to a domain-standard classification pattern are presented to the EDGC for ratification. Example: DEC-2026-109 (Retail Structured Products - Client Reporting Extract), initiated 2026-05-08T14:23:17Z, was resolved at DQSG with EDGC ratification on 2026-05-27T11:05:02Z, and implemented via catalog update MDA-CHG-002913. Escalation timelines are standardized: domain review (up to 5 business days), DQSG review (up to 10 business days), and EDGC ratification (next scheduled meeting or extraordinary session as needed). Issue closure requires evidence of catalog update, steward confirmation, and, when relevant, Records Management crosswalk adjustment.

2.5 Training, Communication, and Attestation

Training on the Data Classification and Governance Policy is mandatory for Data Owners, Data Stewards, and Data Custodians. The required modules are LH-DCG-101 (Foundations of Data Classification) and LH-DCG-201 (Stewardship and Catalog Maintenance). Completion is tracked in Meridian Learning Hub and reconciled quarterly with EDGO records. As of 2026-06-15, completion rates were: Owners 98%, Stewards 96%, Custodians 95% (Ref. EDU-REP-2026Q2). Role-based attestations are captured in the Meridian GRC Portal; control partners review variances and follow up with remedial action plans documented in EDGO-GOV tickets. Communications regarding policy updates are disseminated via the Governance Bulletin (GB-2026-07) and posted to the Data Governance SharePoint hub with links to current artifacts and FAQs.

Section 3. Data Classification Framework

3.1 Overview and Objectives

The Meridian Capital Data Classification Framework establishes a consistent, risk-based method for categorizing information assets to enable proportionate governance, quality management, and records handling across business processes and technology platforms. The framework is intended to be pragmatic and business-aligned, reflecting the materiality of potential impacts to clients, markets, operations, and the firm's reputation. It is applicable to structured, semi-structured, and unstructured data and is implemented through authoritative metadata in the enterprise catalog.

3.2 Classification Levels and Criteria

Meridian Capital adopts four classification levels that are mutually exclusive and collectively exhaustive for enterprise-managed data:

- Public: Information approved for general release without restriction, including published financial reports, marketing collateral post-approval, and publicly accessible product information. Public data requires standard governance oversight to maintain accuracy and brand consistency.
- Internal: Business information intended for use within Meridian Capital, where unauthorized external disclosure would be undesirable but not expected to cause material harm. Examples include process documentation, internal performance dashboards, and routine operational reports. Internal data is shared on a need-aligned basis within the firm.
- Confidential: Sensitive business information where unauthorized disclosure, alteration, or misuse could have tangible adverse effects, including regulatory scrutiny, contractual non-compliance, or client relationship impact. Typical examples include nonpublic client information, transactional data sets not designated as market-facing, and management reporting supporting decision-making.
- Restricted: Highly sensitive information where unauthorized access or misuse could result in significant regulatory, financial, or reputational consequences. Examples include select categories of personally identifiable information processed under strict legal obligations, board-level deliberative materials, and data subject to heightened regulatory handling terms.

Classification is based on potential impact across four dimensions: client trust, regulatory considerations, financial exposure, and contractual commitments. The assessment considers the highest reasonably foreseeable adverse outcome across these dimensions; the most conservative applicable level prevails. Where data sets combine elements of differing sensitivity, the aggregate classification aligns to the most sensitive component unless the data is demonstrably segregable in practice and in governance.

3.3 Assessment Approach and Documentation

Data Stewards conduct initial and periodic classification assessments using the Data Classification Assessment Worksheet (DCG-AW-2026 v1.4). The worksheet captures the business purpose, data elements, consuming processes, geographic considerations, and contractual constraints. Evidence supporting the assigned level, including links to authoritative sources, is recorded in the Meridian Data Atlas (MDA) catalog entry. Data Owners review and approve the assessment; approval history is preserved within the catalog's governance workflow. Any changes to classification status are logged with rationale and timestamped approvals (e.g., MDA-HIST-CL-004782, updated 2026-06-21T09:17:04Z).

3.4 Labeling, Metadata, and Catalog Integration

Classification labels are represented as standardized metadata attributes within the enterprise catalog and propagated through authorized lineage views. Labels must be applied at the lowest practical granularity that the steward can

maintain reliably (e.g., dataset, table, file collection) and must be consistent with domain-level classification standards. The catalog entry includes: classification level, assessment date, next review date, Data Owner and Steward identifiers, and references to applicable records retention schedules. The Records Retention Mapping Crosswalk (RMS-XW-2026 v3.3) links classification levels to retention categories, ensuring that records management practices remain aligned with the data's defined sensitivity and business purpose.

3.5 Reassessment Triggers and Review Cadence

Classification decisions are reviewed at least annually and more frequently upon material changes to business context, data composition, or usage patterns. Triggers include mergers and acquisitions, entry into new markets, onboarding of significant consumers, or material contract changes. For example, RCL-REV-2026-031 (Wealth Advisory Client Insights Mart), initiated 2026-05-30T08:52:19Z and closed 2026-06-21T09:17:04Z, advanced the dataset from Internal to Confidential following expansion of analytics attributes approved by the Data Owner. The review cadence for Restricted datasets is semi-annual, with interim confirmation required for high-visibility processes as directed by the EDGC.

3.6 Cross-Border and Residency Considerations

Where data residency requirements apply, Data Stewards coordinate with the Privacy Office and Records Management to confirm that classification decisions appropriately reflect jurisdictional obligations and contractual terms. The Cross-Border Data Working Note (CBD-WN-2026-02) provides a reference checklist for residency determination and documentation. Any jurisdictional overlays that affect data handling expectations are recorded in the catalog with links to governing agreements or notices, ensuring transparency for downstream consumers and auditability for control partners. Residency annotations do not alter the base classification level but may impose additional governance steps which are tracked in the catalog as compliance attributes.

3.7 Metrics, Coverage, and Continuous Improvement

The effectiveness of the classification framework is measured through enterprise metrics maintained by EDGO and reviewed by the EDGC. As of Q2 FY26, classification coverage across cataloged assets measured 92.4% against a 95.0% target, with 18 of 20 priority domains above threshold and two domains (Corporate Functions Analytics and Third-Party Data Feeds) on remediation plans (EDGO-GOV-4312 and EDGO-GOV-4325). Median time to initial classification for new assets was 9 business days from catalog onboarding, within the 10-day service objective. Automated recommendations within the catalog platform provided 68% suggestion accuracy at the level designation, with 21% requiring steward adjustment and 11% escalated for multi-stakeholder review (Ref. GM-Pack-Q2FY26, sections "Coverage" and "Recommendation Quality"). Trend analysis indicates steady improvement in both coverage and cycle time following deployment of the standardized worksheet and enhanced steward training completed in May 2026.

Continuous improvement is driven by retrospectives conducted quarterly with Data Stewards, captured in Lessons Learned Log LL-DCG-2026-Q2. Action items from these sessions inform incremental updates to guidance materials and steward enablement sessions. The EDGC reviews a subset of reclassification decisions each quarter to validate consistency of application across domains and to ensure that the framework remains aligned to evolving business needs and external obligations. Any proposed framework refinements are documented in EDGO-GOV tickets, undergo consultation with control partners, and, upon approval, are reflected in the next policy review cycle to maintain currency and clarity for all stakeholders.

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Section 3. Roles, Accountability, and Decision Rights

Meridian Capital's data governance operating model is grounded in clear assignment of authority and accountability across business and technology domains. Ownership of business meaning and usage rests with the first line of defense, while control design and challenge are performed by independent functions. Decision rights are defined to minimize ambiguity, promote timely execution, and ensure that classification outcomes are consistently applied across data domains. This structure is codified in DGO Charter Ref. DGO-CH-2026-02 and reviewed annually by the Data Governance Council (DGC).

3.1 Data Owners (First Line)

A Data Owner is the accountable executive for classification, usage approval, and lifecycle outcomes for a defined data domain (e.g., Client, Trade, Market, Finance). Data Owners are appointed by the relevant Business Head and recorded in the Data Authority Register (DAR) under record keys DAR-CLNT-01 through DAR-FIN-07, maintained by the DGO. Responsibilities include endorsing initial classification decisions, approving material classification changes triggered by new use cases, and attesting to compliance with metadata and retention requirements. Data Owners ensure that domain-aligned processes incorporate classification labels at origination and that business teams understand permissible dissemination. Quarterly, Data Owners provide written attestations (see Attestation Batch ATST-Q2-2026, 2026-06-28T17:00Z) confirming that domain datasets are accurately classified in the enterprise catalog and that any remediation items are captured in the service management queue. Ownership changes must be recorded within five business days in the DAR; reference ticket SNOW-REQ-673829 shows the most recent transfer for the Corporate Actions dataset.

3.2 Data Stewards (First Line)

Data Stewards act on behalf of the Data Owner to operationalize classification outcomes and maintain data context. They curate business metadata, coordinate with Technology to embed labels in pipelines, and monitor data quality indicators relevant to classification (e.g., presence of personal identifiers, trading strategy text). Stewards maintain stewardship backlogs in Jira (e.g., DGSR-2026-1045, DGSR-2026-1093) and partner with the Metadata Operations Team to complete catalog enrichment. Stewards also prepare materials for DGC meetings, including lineage visuals and mapping of controls to classification levels, ensuring transparency and audit readiness. Performance of stewardship obligations is tracked through the Stewardship Compliance Score (SCS), a composite metric derived from on-time attestation, catalog completeness, and timely closure of remediation tasks.

3.3 Data Custodians (Technology)

Data Custodians, primarily within Corporate Technology Operations (CTO) and the Data Platforms & Integration (DPI) team, are responsible for implementing and sustaining classification labels at the system and integration layers. While Custodians do not set business classification, they are accountable for ensuring that labels, tags, and metadata attributes persist through data movement and that catalog synchronization jobs complete within defined SLAs. Custodians manage service queues related to tagging failures, catalog ingestion defects, and schema drift that may affect classification fidelity (e.g., SNOW-INC-884216 opened 2026-05-17T09:42Z and resolved 2026-05-18T13:06Z by DPI). Custodial work is monitored via weekly operational reviews chaired by the CTO Data Services Manager, with outcomes recorded in the DataOps Review Log (DORL-2026-WK21).

3.4 Control Partners (Second Line and Independent Functions)

The Information Risk & Control (IRC) function serves as second line for classification governance, conducting thematic reviews and challenging first line decisions against regulatory obligations and enterprise risk appetite definitions. IRC

maintains the Classification Control Library (CCL), which maps classification levels to required control themes (e.g., access governance, vendor oversight, retention). Legal & Compliance provides interpretive guidance on regulatory data categories while Internal Audit independently assesses the effectiveness of the classification framework through periodic audits (latest audit ref: IA-24-DC-003, fieldwork concluded 2026-05-10). Findings and management action plans are logged in the Enterprise Issue Management (EIM) tool with cross-links to relevant datasets and owners; EIM-DC-2026-014 tracks remediation concerning completeness of lineage for certain market data feeds.

3.5 Governance Forums and Review Cadence

The Data Governance Council (DGC) is the senior decision-making forum for classification standards and escalations. It convenes monthly, chaired by the Chief Data Officer (CDO). Agendas include review of classification metrics, material change requests, and thematic risk findings. Minutes are recorded under DGC-MIN-YYYYMM-DD; for example, DGC-MIN-202606-21 documents the approval of the 2026 metadata minimums and endorsement of the quarterly classification attestation results. Supporting forums include:

- Domain Working Groups (DWGs): Monthly sessions focused on domain-specific classification implementation, chaired by Data Owners or delegates. Recent DWG-TRADE-2026-06 addressed harmonization of portfolio strategy descriptors.
- Technology Enablement Review (TER): Biweekly CTO-led meeting to ensure platform alignment and to track deprecation/upgrade impacts on labeling persistence; see TER-2026-12 for catalog connector rollout status.
- IRC Challenge Clinics: Quarterly reviews targeting consistency of interpretation across high-impact datasets; session logs (IRC-CC-2026-Q2) reflect guidance on cross-border data handling alignment with classification levels.

3.6 Documentation and Evidence Management

All classification artifacts are maintained in the enterprise data catalog and linked collaboration repositories. The canonical inventory resides in the Catalog of Record (CoR), with dataset GUIDs serving as the unifying keys (e.g., GUID-CLNT-4231A, GUID-MKT-7720C). Evidence supporting classification decisions, including lineage extracts, data profiling summaries, legal memos, and DGC approvals, is retained in the DGO-controlled SharePoint workspace (Site ID: SP-DGO-1462) and mirrored to the Records Management archive per retention schedules. Versioned documents carry the applicable dataset GUID, version date stamp (UTC), and approver UPN; sample: CLNT-4231A_CLASS_DECISION_v2026-06-20T15:30Z_approved@meridiancap.com. ServiceNow and Jira tickets referenced in these artifacts must include the dataset GUID and classification level in their metadata fields to support traceability and audit queries. The DGO performs monthly completeness checks against these linkages; the 2026-06 check (DGO-QC-2026-06, completed 2026-06-29T18:12Z) reported 98.4% link coverage and opened five remediation tasks for missing lineage attachments.

3.7 Decision Rights Clarification

Decision rights are delineated to avoid duplication and to expedite resolution. Data Owners approve initial classification and material reclassifications; Data Stewards recommend and execute routine catalog updates; Custodians implement enabling controls; IRC issues formal challenges where necessary; DGC makes binding determinations on contested matters. In case files where urgency requires interim designation pending DGC review, the Data Owner's endorsement serves as the temporary authority and must be recorded with a time-bounded validity in the CoR metadata. The DGO tracks all interim designations and ensures their conversion to final status following the next DGC meeting. As evidenced in case DGCR-2026-045, the interim classification for an analytics dataset was ratified within two weeks, reflecting adherence to the defined governance cycle.

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Section 4. Classification Levels and Criteria

Meridian Capital applies a four-tier classification model designed to support regulatory compliance, client obligations, and prudent risk management. Classification is determined by business context, legal constraints, contractual commitments, and potential impact from unintended disclosure or misuse. Each level is defined by sensitivity, required control themes, and distribution posture. Determinations are recorded in the enterprise catalog and supported by documented rationale and evidence, as described in Section 3.6.

4.1 Level Definitions

- Public: Data intended for unrestricted dissemination, including content published on meridiancap.com, corporate press releases, and regulatory filings once formally submitted and publicly available. Although broadly accessible, such data remains subject to accuracy, records, and branding standards. Catalog entries for Public data reference communications approvals (e.g., MKT-APR-2026-031) to affirm release status.

- Internal: Business information suitable for use by Meridian Capital personnel and approved contractors under standard confidentiality agreements. Examples include internal policies, non-client-specific operational reporting, and training materials. Internal data requires baseline governance controls with no external distribution absent authorized channels. The catalog denotes Internal with the tag CLASS=INTERNAL and links to the owner's attestation.

- Confidential: Data that, if improperly disclosed, could cause client, regulatory, or commercial impact. Representative examples include client account attributes, transaction details, pricing arrangements, proprietary models, and operational metrics containing limited identifiers. Confidential data is subject to enhanced governance with specific oversight on sharing, vendor usage, and data residency. The catalog entry will include a completed impact rationale, legal reference, and Data Owner approval (e.g., CLNT-4231A_CLASS_DECISION_v2026-06-20T15:30Z).

- Restricted: Data of heightened sensitivity whose exposure could result in significant regulatory, financial, or reputational harm. This level encompasses sensitive personal information, strategic deal documentation, pre-public financials, and select trading or risk parameters. Restricted datasets are governed with the most stringent control themes, heightened monitoring, and strict distribution restrictions. Restricted designation requires explicit DGC ratification noted in council minutes and catalog status flags (e.g., DGC-MIN-202606-21; dataset GUID-RSK-9812F).

4.2 Classification Criteria and Rationale

Classification determinations consider: the presence and granularity of personal data; contractual obligations with clients and counterparties; regulatory categorizations under applicable jurisdictions; market sensitivity of the content; aggregation levels; and the business context of intended use. The DGO maintains a reference compendium mapping common data elements to indicative levels, updated semiannually based on regulatory guidance and audit feedback. While this compendium aids consistency, final classification reflects the composite of factors captured in the decision record and validated by the Data Owner. For instance, aggregated metrics lacking identifiers may be Confidential due to business sensitivity even where no personal data is present. Conversely, certain identifiers may necessitate Restricted handling when combined with specific contextual fields. All decisions cite source references (Legal memos, control library entries) and include a review horizon date.

4.3 Labeling and Catalog Tagging Standards

All datasets registered in the Catalog of Record must carry a single primary classification level and may include secondary sensitivity qualifiers (e.g., TIME-CRITICAL, CLIENT-SPECIFIC) to enhance downstream handling rules. Labels are applied using controlled vocabulary values maintained by the Metadata Operations Team (Metadata Dictionary Ref. MDD-2026-05). Each dataset record must also populate the following minimum metadata: Business Owner UPN, Steward UPN, Domain, Data Element Summary, Regulatory Relevance Indicator, Residency Indicator, Retention Category Reference, and Lineage Summary. Tagging must be consistently propagated to views, extracts, and scheduled outputs; Custodian teams ensure synchronization jobs complete within established SLAs, with exceptions logged for remediation (SNOW-TASK-902714 closed 2026-06-22T11:08Z after successful tag repair on a finance reporting extract). Label presentation in user-facing catalogs reflects definitive values; deprecated labels, if any, remain searchable but are flagged with end dates and mapped successors to preserve historical traceability.

4.4 Metrics, Monitoring, and Attestation

The DGO monitors classification health through key indicators published in the monthly Data Governance Scorecard. As of the 2026-06 cycle (DGS-2026-06, published 2026-06-30T14:00Z):

- Catalog Coverage: 96.7% of in-scope datasets carry a current primary classification (target >= 95.0%). Coverage improved 1.2pp month-over-month following completion of DWG remediation tasks DGSR-2026-1045 and DGSR-2026-1088.
- Attestation Timeliness: 94.3% of Data Owner attestations submitted by the due date (target >= 95.0%); three domains submitted within the grace window and have action plans to meet the next cycle timelines.
- Accuracy Validation: 98.1% of sampled classifications aligned with IRC validation outcomes (target >= 97.0%). Two variances were identified in market analytics outputs and are tracked in EIM-DC-2026-016 with expected closure 2026-08-15.
- Tag Propagation Health: 99.2% of lineage hops retained classification tags during scheduled synchronization tests (target >= 99.0%). One transient defect (SNOW-INC-889302) was resolved without downstream distribution.

Quarterly, the DGO performs thematic reviews focusing on high-impact domains and cross-border datasets. The Q2 review (DGO-THM-2026-Q2) sampled 45 datasets designated Restricted and confirmed that rationale statements adequately cited regulatory considerations and contractual clauses where applicable. The DGC endorsed the findings and requested a focused review of vendor-hosted datasets in Q3 to validate consistency of catalog labels with third-party inventories.

4.5 Cross-Border, Third-Party, and Records Alignment

Classification outcomes must align with cross-border data handling considerations documented by Legal & Compliance. Data with jurisdictional restrictions includes catalog attributes indicating permitted processing and storage locations, along with the authoritative reference. For third-party engagements, Vendor Management and IRC review the vendor data inventory to confirm that classification labels are recognized and that contractual documents reflect appropriate data handling posture. The Third-Party Data Review log (TPDR-2026-06) records confirmations for six vendors onboarding analytics datasets; two vendors required updates to inventory mappings prior to go-live (TPDR-ACT-2026-06-04). Records Management ensures that classification is harmonized with retention schedules; datasets carry a Retention Category Reference linking to the Records Schedule Identifier (e.g., RS-CLNT-12, RS-TRD-07). Annual alignment checks verify that Restricted and Confidential datasets have explicit retention determinations and that destruction or archival criteria are documented at the dataset level in the catalog.

4.6 Continuous Improvement

Classification is periodically recalibrated to reflect changes in regulatory environment, business models, and data usage

patterns. The Semiannual Standards Review (SSR) process, logged under SSR-2026-H1, evaluates emerging data types, updates the indicative mapping compendium, and recommends refinements to metadata minimums. Approved changes are recorded in DGC minutes and scheduled for rollout via the Technology Enablement Review cadence. Completion is tracked through ServiceNow change tasks and evidenced in the catalog change log, ensuring traceability from policy intent to operational implementation. The 2026-H1 SSR introduced clarifications on analytical feature stores and re-affirmed primary label precedence when multiple qualifiers are present, with full adoption confirmed by 2026-06-30T23:00Z in the DGS-2026-06 audit trail.

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Section 5. Data Inventory and Catalog Maintenance

5.1 Enterprise Data Catalog Scope and Content

Meridian Capital maintains a centralized Enterprise Data Catalog (EDC) as the authoritative register of structured and semi-structured data assets in scope of this Policy (Ref: MCGP-DC-001 v2.3, Section 2). The EDC enumerates datasets produced, consumed, or curated by enterprise platforms, including but not limited to analytic warehouses, operational data stores, reporting marts, regulatory submission repositories, and approved third-party data feeds. For each registered dataset, the catalog record includes, at minimum: business title; system of record or source; business purpose aligned to an approved use case taxonomy; classification label as defined in Section 3; dataset owner and data steward with directory identifiers; data domain and sub-domain; critical data element (CDE) indicators; retention category per Records and Information Management (RIM) schedule; distribution profile (internal, inter-affiliate, vendor); last certified date; lineage summary; and data quality scoring metadata.

The Data Governance Office (DGO) is accountable for EDC standards, schema, and change control, while Data Platform Operations (DPO) ensures catalog service availability, access provisioning, and integration with pipeline registration mechanisms. Data Domain Stewards within each business-aligned data council are responsible for the accuracy and completeness of descriptive metadata and for timely attestation activities. The EDC is deemed a Tier 1 control repository for purposes of operational risk and audit evidence collection.

5.2 Dataset Registration and Onboarding

All new datasets that are persistently stored, repeatedly produced, or broadly consumed by more than one functional area must be registered in the EDC prior to first production availability. Registration encompasses population of required metadata fields, assignment of classification labels consistent with Section 3.2, confirmation of data ownership (business and technical), declaration of CDEs, and linkage to applicable data quality rules. DPO facilitates registration through the enterprise intake workflow, while the requesting squad must designate an accountable business owner and steward prior to approval. The EDC does not accept records without identified custodians, and records without classification labels are auto-flagged for remediation.

During the onboarding phase, DGO verifies that glossary terms referenced in the submission correspond to approved definitions in the Enterprise Business Glossary (EBG). Where new terms are proposed, the DGO coordinates review with the Enterprise Data Stewardship Council (EDSC). The lineage summary entered at onboarding must reflect the logical flow from source domain to target domain with system-of-record markers. Physical lineage artifacts may be attached as evidence where applicable, but the catalog record itself remains descriptive and technology-agnostic.

5.3 Periodic Recertification and Attestations

All active EDC records undergo periodic recertification to sustain policy alignment and metadata currency. Recertification cadence is defined as quarterly for datasets labeled Confidential and biannually for datasets labeled Internal. Public datasets may follow an annual cadence unless otherwise mandated by regulatory commitments. Recertification requires the dataset owner and steward to jointly attest to the validity of classification labels, owner/steward assignments, data domain mapping, CDE flags, retention category, and lineage summary. Where changes are identified, a standard change request must be logged to update the EDC and, as needed, downstream metadata repositories.

The DGO coordinates attestation waves and issues campaign notifications via enterprise workflow tooling. Each attestation captures the attestor's name, role, timestamp (UTC), and disposition. Campaign evidence is retained for not

less than five years in alignment with the Corporate Audit Evidence Standard. Illustrative completion log entries for the Q2 cycle include: MC-GOV-ATT-2026-Q2-0197 (2026-06-14T09:42:18Z, Global Markets Data Steward, certified), MC-GOV-ATT-2026-Q2-0241 (2026-06-15T16:05:51Z, Retail Banking Data Owner, update required), and MC-GOV-ATT-2026-Q2-0303 (2026-06-20T12:21:07Z, Risk Analytics Data Steward, certified). Items flagged "update required" trigger follow-up tickets for metadata correction and, if relevant, reclassification reviews.

5.4 Metrics and Reporting

The EDC is monitored through a defined set of key performance indicators (KPIs) and operational metrics reported to the Data Governance Steering Committee (DGSC) monthly. Core KPIs include: catalog coverage (registered datasets as a percentage of eligible datasets), timely registration (percentage of datasets registered prior to production availability), attestation completion rate by due date, stale record rate (records with last certified date older than policy threshold), lineage completeness (presence of upstream/downstream references and system-of-record markers), and CDE completeness (percentage of declared CDEs with linked quality rules). As of the 2026-06 reporting cycle (Report Ref: DGSC-2026-06-EDC), catalog coverage measured 96.8% against a target of 98.0%, timely registration measured 92.4% against a target of 95.0%, and stale record rate measured 3.1% against a threshold of <=2.0%.

Operational metrics are reviewed at the DGO weekly stand-up. The 2026-06-21 session (Meeting ID: DGO-WSU-2026-25, 08:30-09:00 UTC) documented 57 open remediation items associated with stale records, with 41 assigned to Retail & Wealth domains and 16 to Corporate Lending. Average age of open remediation items was 18.6 business days. Ticket references included SNOW: MC-SNOW-GOV-24317 (stale record remediation, Corporate Treasury), SNOW: MC-SNOW-GOV-24402 (owner re-assignment, Wealth Data Mart), and JIRA: DGOV-1278 (lineage enrichment, Merchant Acquiring). DGO noted an improving trend in lineage completeness following targeted stewardship workshops conducted during May (Training Log: DGO-TRN-2026-05-GL-02).

5.5 Findings, Remediation, and Continuous Improvement

Internal Audit (IA) completed a limited-scope review of EDC controls on 2026-05-29 (Audit Ref: IA-DATA-2026-07). Observations included: (1) inconsistent use of standardized business purpose descriptors in 14 of 120 sampled records; (2) missing CDE indicators in 6 of 120 sampled records within the Corporate Lending domain; and (3) delayed recertification completion in two steward groups past the quarterly deadline. All observations were rated low to moderate significance and were addressed through a corrective action plan coordinated by DGO and domain stewards.

Remediation actions were logged under CAP Plan ID: DGO-CAP-2026-EDC-01 with target dates between 2026-07-31 and 2026-08-30. As of 2026-07-15T14:32:10Z, remediation progress reported 78% completion, with standardized purpose descriptors fully remediated (Task IDs: DGOV-1291 to DGOV-1296), CDE flagging 67% complete (Task IDs: DGOV-1302 to DGOV-1309), and recertification timeliness addressed via updated steward coverage rotas in Retail & Wealth (HR ticket: HR-ROTA-2026-112). DGO will integrate a catalog field validation rule to enforce standardized descriptors at point of entry and will provide refresher guidance to stewards in the Q3 governance forum. These changes are recorded in the Catalog Standards Change Log (Entry: CAT-STD-2026-09, approved by DGSC on 2026-07-12).

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Section 6. Metadata and Lineage Standards

6.1 Minimum Metadata Standard

Meridian Capital requires a consistent baseline of metadata for all cataloged datasets to support discoverability, risk management, and regulatory reporting. The minimum standard includes: (a) descriptive metadata (title, description aligned to the EBG, business owner, steward); (b) structural metadata (schema name, entity count, update frequency as a controlled vocabulary, and data domain classification); (c) classification metadata (policy label per Section 3.2 and any relevant regulatory designations); (d) quality metadata (CDE indicators, linked quality rules with measurement frequency and rule owners, and last measurement outcome); and (e) lineage metadata (source/consumer summaries, system-of-record identification, and transformation context at a logical level). Each field must be populated using approved controlled vocabularies where available to promote semantic consistency and reduce reconciliation overhead across domains.

The EBG serves as the canonical glossary for business terms and CDE definitions. The DGO curates the EBG with input from domain councils and publishes monthly updates (Release Notes: EBG-RN-2026-06, EBG-RN-2026-07). Dataset records must reference EBG terms rather than freeform descriptions wherever a term exists. Where a new or revised term is necessary, stewards initiate a glossary change request referencing the associated dataset tickets and proposed definitions. The EDSC adjudicates glossary changes within the standard service target of 15 business days and documents decisions, rationales, and version increments.

6.2 Lineage Capture and Verification

Lineage is captured at two complementary levels to balance accuracy with operational practicality: logical lineage (data domains, sources, and consumer pathways described in business terms) and standardized transformation context (e.g., join, aggregate, derive indicated at a categorical level). The intent is to provide traceability sufficient to support impact analysis, regulatory inquiries, and quality incident triage without overburdening product teams with unnecessary technical detail. For designated regulatory reporting datasets, lineage must additionally identify the chain of accountability by role (owner, steward, and control reviewer) to support attestations required by the Regulatory Reporting Controls Framework.

Verification of lineage accuracy is performed during onboarding, during recertification events, and in response to material changes in upstream sources or downstream consumption. The DGO conducts sampling-based spot checks monthly, selecting a minimum of 5% of datasets in each domain or five datasets, whichever is greater. The 2026-06 lineage verification memo (Memo: DGO-LIN-VER-2026-06) reported 94.1% conformance to standard, with remediation tasks raised for missing consumer references (JIRA: DGOV-1317, DGOV-1321) and ambiguous source descriptors (JIRA: DGOV-1323). All identified gaps were assigned to domain stewards with a 20 business day target completion and tracked through the governance dashboard.

6.3 Data Quality Governance

Data quality (DQ) governance is integrated with metadata and lineage to ensure critical elements are understood, monitored, and improved. CDEs must have defined quality rules with clear dimensions (accuracy, completeness, timeliness, consistency, uniqueness) and measurement cadences, along with an accountable rule owner. Rule definitions are stored in the Quality Rule Library and linked to the EDC entries for traceability. Quality measurement outcomes are summarized as a rolling 90-day score for each dataset, displayed in the EDC to promote transparency

and facilitate prioritization.

DQ incidents are logged through the enterprise issue management process when measurement outcomes breach predefined operating thresholds. During 2026-Q2, 23 DQ incidents were raised across four domains (Incident Range: DQ-INC-2026-044 to DQ-INC-2026-066). The majority (61%) pertained to completeness deviations in onboarding attributes for small business lending, traced to delayed upstream enrichment. Remediation closed within the target window for 20 of 23 incidents; three incidents required extended monitoring through July (Extensions: DQ-INC-2026-059-E1, DQ-INC-2026-061-E1, DQ-INC-2026-064-E1). The Risk & Compliance Analytics (RCA) team reviewed corrective actions and confirmed that residual risk remained within appetite as documented in the Q2 Data Risk Report (RCA-DRR-2026-Q2).

6.4 Classification Change Management

Classification labels are subject to change based on evolving content, usage context, or regulatory guidance. Changes to dataset classification must follow the standardized governance workflow to ensure proper review, impact assessment, and communication. Requests are initiated by the business owner or steward via the governance ticketing queue with rationale linked to evidence (e.g., updated use case approval, modification of data fields). DGO performs an initial sufficiency check and routes the request to the relevant domain council for endorsement. Where cross-domain impacts are identified, the DGSC adjudicates final disposition.

Illustrative tickets from the 2026-Q2 cycle include: MC-GOV-CLF-2026-072 (Retail Deposits Reporting Mart; requested change from Internal to Confidential due to enrichment with sensitive customer attributes; approved 2026-05-18T11:07:44Z), MC-GOV-CLF-2026-083 (Market Data Snapshot; requested change from Confidential to Internal following removal of proprietary vendor attributes; conditionally approved pending vendor contract alignment, resolved 2026-06-10T15:53:29Z), and MC-GOV-CLF-2026-091 (SME Risk Scoring Features; no change; rationale insufficient). All determinations are recorded in the Classification Decision Log with references to the EDC record IDs and attendant notifications to subscribing consumers.

6.5 Audit Readiness and Evidence Retention

To maintain audit readiness, Meridian Capital preserves metadata change records, attestation outcomes, lineage verification memos, and DQ incident closeout summaries as formal evidence. Evidence retention aligns with the Corporate Audit Evidence Standard and the RIM schedule, with a minimum retention of five years for governance artifacts. Evidence must be retrievable by dataset, domain, and reporting period within reasonable timeframes as defined by the Audit Service Level Charter.

Internal and external assurance activities are supported through a standing evidence package that includes: the latest EDC extract for in-scope datasets; attestation campaign reports; lineage verification sampling results and remediation tracking; quality rule inventories and 90-day score summaries; and a listing of classification changes over the prior 12 months with decision rationales. The 2026-07-08 evidence package prepared for IA (Package ID: IA-REQ-2026-07-EDG) met all completeness and timeliness criteria, with IA acknowledgment recorded at 2026-07-10T10:18:02Z. Where clarifications are requested, the DGO coordinates consolidated responses across DPO, domain stewards, and RCA to ensure consistent messaging and traceability.

6.6 Performance and Risk Metrics

The DGSC monitors a consolidated dashboard of governance performance and risk indicators. As of the July 2026 cycle (Dashboard Ref: DGSC-DB-2026-07), the following were recorded: (a) EDC catalog coverage at 97.3% (trend improving), (b) lineage completeness at 93.8% (flat), (c) attestation on-time rate at 95.6% (above target), (d) average

DQ incident time-to-close at 8.4 business days (target <=10), and (e) classification change average cycle time at 12.2 business days (target <=15). The stale record rate within Wealth was identified as an emerging watch item at 2.6% (threshold <=2.0%), with a corrective plan underway (CAP: DGO-CAP-2026-EDC-02).

The DGSC directed the DGO to present a Q3 plan emphasizing glossary adoption consistency, targeted steward enablement for complex lineage scenarios, and closer integration of DQ outcomes into quarterly business reviews. These actions are logged in the Governance Roadmap (Roadmap ID: DGO-RMP-2026-H2) with milestones, accountable owners, and reporting checkpoints to sustain momentum and reinforce policy adherence across business lines.

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6. Data Stewardship and Ownership Model

Meridian Capital's data stewardship and ownership model establishes accountable roles for the lifecycle governance of data assets across business lines and platforms. The model distinguishes between the Data Owner (business executive accountable for use, quality, and compliance within a defined domain), the Data Steward (operational role responsible for day-to-day governance actions and coordination), the System Custodian (technology role overseeing the hosting platform and operational integrity of data systems), and the Data User (employees and contractors consuming data in accordance with permitted purposes). Role charters are maintained by the Data Governance Office (DGO) and are version-controlled under repository GOV-CHAR-REG-01, with the current approved version 3.2 ratified by the Data Governance Council (DGC) on 2026-05-28 at 10:00 ET, recorded in meeting minutes DGC-MM-2026-05.

Data Owners are appointed by the relevant Business Unit Executive in consultation with Information Risk Management (IRM) and Legal & Compliance (L&C), ensuring alignment between regulatory accountabilities and operational oversight. Each appointment defines a scope statement, including in-scope systems-of-record, reference data sets, and derived data pipelines. Data Stewards are nominated by the Data Owner and confirmed by the DGO following verification of competency criteria, training completion, and conflict-of-interest checks. System Custodians are designated by Enterprise Architecture & Platforms (EAP) and documented through configuration records in CMDB reference CMDB-CI-DATA-ALL, with cross-references to the stewardship registry. All assignments and changes are recorded through ServiceNow change tickets (e.g., SNOW-CHG-0041927 closed 2026-06-11 16:42 ET by EAP/Platform Operations) to maintain auditability of role coverage.

6.1 Stewardship Appointment and Tenure

Stewardship appointments are for a standard 24-month term with mid-term confirmation at 12 months. Nominations are initiated via the Data Stewardship Register request type in the DGO service catalog (reference DGO-SC-REG), linked to a JIRA workflow for approvals (e.g., GOV-JIRA-1462 approved 2026-06-03 09:18 ET by DGO Governance Lead). Appointees must maintain an active Meridian training profile, remain within the policy-defined organizational unit, and not simultaneously hold roles that could create conflicting accountabilities (e.g., internal audit assignment within the same data domain). The DGO produces a quarterly coverage report, evidencing that 100% of Tier 1 domains had designated Data Owners and 98.6% had designated Stewards as of 2026-06-30 (2 open items tracked under DGO-TRACK-2026-287 and DGO-TRACK-2026-293, both with remediation plans due Q3).

6.2 Onboarding and Continuing Education

All Data Owners and Stewards must complete the Data Classification Foundations module and the Data Governance Responsibilities module within 90 days of appointment. Continuing education is required annually and is refreshed to reflect changes in regulatory expectations, emerging operational practices, and lessons from assurance activities. Training completions are recorded in the Learning Management System (LMS) under learning path DGO-LP-CLASS-01, with evidence synchronized daily to the stewardship registry. As of 2026-06-30 21:00 ET, automated LMS feed DGO-TRN-FEED-2026-06 reported 97.2% on-time completion for newly appointed Stewards (n=107), with four in grace period statuses and two escalations to Business Unit leadership (ref. ESC-DGO-2026-015 and ESC-DGO-2026-016). The DGO monitors training quality through post-course assessment analytics; the trailing-quarter mean assessment score was 88.4%, with targeted content updates scheduled under SNOW-CHG-0042311 to improve clarity around borderline classification scenarios.

6.3 Delegations and Coverage

Temporary delegations are permitted for planned absences or workload peaks, provided there is continuity of governance decisions and documentation quality. Delegations are time-boxed, must be approved by the Data Owner (for Steward delegations) or the DGC Secretariat (for Owner delegations), and are documented via delegation records (DLG-REG-YYYY-SEQ) with explicit start and end dates. As of 2026-06-15, there were 23 active delegations (median duration 14 days) with no coverage gaps detected by the DGO automated assurance script MC-DGO-ASSURE-17, evidenced by the 2026-06 monthly compliance pack DGO-COMP-2026-06. Coverage metrics are presented to the DGC in the monthly dashboard, which also highlights upcoming delegation expiries to prompt renewal or reversion notifications.

7. Classification Review Cadence and Evidence Collection

The classification review cadence is designed to uphold currency and consistency of classifications across systems, records, and derived data. All Tier 1 data domains must undergo a comprehensive classification attestation annually, while Tier 2 and Tier 3 domains follow an 18-month and 24-month cadence respectively. Independent of cadence, material change triggers (e.g., new data elements introduced to systems-of-record, change in business use, third-party onboarding, or regulatory developments) initiate interim reviews to confirm that classifications remain appropriate. Reviews are recorded in the Governance Review Register (GRR) with unique identifiers (e.g., GRR-2026-0817 for the Treasury Liquidity Data review completed 2026-06-07 15:26 ET).

7.1 Review Triggers and Coordination

Material change triggers are sourced through three input channels: technology change control notifications from EAP, new product approval outputs from the Product Governance Committee, and external developments from L&C. For example, CRQ-EDP-2026-2198 (deployment of a schema expansion within the Enterprise Data Platform) triggered GRR-2026-0799 on 2026-05-30, resulting in a limited-scope attestation within 10 business days and a no-change conclusion for pre-existing classifications. Similarly, LEG-ALERT-2026-044 (interpretive guidance update issued 2026-06-12 08:03 ET) prompted an out-of-cycle review in Wealth Advisory Data (GRR-2026-0824), with revised narrative justifications added to the classification rationale repository.

7.2 Evidence and Artefact Standards

Each review must produce a complete artefact set comprising: the updated Data Inventory extract aligned to the corporate metadata standard (GOV-META-STD v5.1), the signed classification attestation by the Data Owner, a rationale statement referencing data elements and business use, and, where relevant, linkage to third-party data handling clauses maintained by L&C. Evidence is stored in the centralized repository GOV-EVID-CLASS with cross-links to the metadata application of record. Artefact completeness is validated by the DGO within five business days of submission; any gaps are logged as documentation findings (e.g., DGO-FND-2026-0312 closed 2026-06-19 12:47 ET following receipt of a corrected rationale statement from Corporate Lending).

7.3 Sampling and Quality Review

To ensure classifications are applied consistently at the data element level, the DGO applies a risk-weighted sampling methodology calibrated each quarter in consultation with IRM. For the period ending 2026-06-30, the sample size was set at a minimum of 10% of elements for Tier 1 domains, subject to a floor of 50 elements per domain, with increased sampling for domains with prior documentation findings. The Q2 aggregate concurrence rate between Steward-applied classification and independent DGO review was 96.8%, with 3.2% requiring minor narrative enhancement and 0.4% logged as misclassification requiring correction (two items within Capital Markets Reference Data, both remediated under GOV-JIRA-1499 by 2026-06-28). No issues were escalated beyond routine remediation thresholds, and the DGC noted steady improvement over the preceding three quarters.

7.4 Scheduling and Backlog Management

The DGO maintains a rolling six-month review calendar published to all stakeholders on the first business day of each month. Where resource constraints or competing priorities arise, scheduling adjustments are managed through the Review Planning Forum with Business Unit and EAP representation. As of the 2026-06 cycle, there were three reschedules within the same quarter (refs. GRR-RS-2026-020 through -022), each supported by documented rationale and alternate dates within the published window. The backlog stood at zero at quarter-end, with no impact on the annual coverage objectives.

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8. Metrics, Key Risk Indicators, and Reporting

Meridian Capital monitors a defined set of Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) and Key Risk Indicators (KRIs) to evidence operational effectiveness of data classification and broader data governance. KPI measures focus on execution (e.g., review timeliness, training completion, stewardship coverage), while KRIs focus on exposure (e.g., volume of unclassified assets, overdue reviews, and discrepancies across systems). Metrics are compiled monthly by the DGO Analytics team and validated by IRM prior to distribution. The Executive Data Governance Dashboard (EDGD) is issued on the fifth business day (e.g., EDGD-2026-06 published 2026-07-08 09:00 ET) and reviewed at the Data Governance Council meeting within the same month.

For the period ending 2026-06-30, KPI performance was as follows: classification review on-time completion rate of 98.3% against a target of >=97%; stewardship role coverage of 99.2% for Tier 1 domains against a target of 100%; training on-time completion of 97.2% for newly appointed Stewards and 95.6% annual refresh across all incumbents against a target of >=95%. KRI readings included 0.6% of cataloged data sets flagged as "classification pending" (target <=1.0%), 1.1% of reviews in "approaching due" status (within 30 days of due date), and 0.3% discrepancy rate between the metadata application of record and downstream consumption layers as detected by reconciliation controls. All outliers were within management appetite set by the DGC (ref. DGC-APP-2026-01).

8.1 Metadata Quality and Fitness

Sustained governance depends on reliable metadata. The DGO's Metadata Quality Program evaluates completeness, consistency, and validity of critical fields, including data element name, business definition, classification label, authoritative source, and Data Owner assignment. In Q2 2026, field completeness across Tier 1 domains averaged 99.1% (prior quarter 98.7%), with two domains targeted for improvement initiatives due to definitional ambiguities identified in IRM's spot checks (IRM-RSK-2026-0054 and IRM-RSK-2026-0059). Duplicative entries in the catalog decreased to 0.4% following cleansing activity executed by EAP under change ticket SNOW-CHG-0042059, resulting in a notable decline in classification inquiry tickets (EDP-SR-2026-11412 and -11437) related to catalog confusion. The DGO has scheduled a data definition harmonization workshop series for Q3 (DGO-WS-2026-03) to further reduce definitional variance and enhance reuse.

8.2 Reporting Cadence and Governance Forums

Reporting is structured to enable oversight at appropriate levels. Monthly operational reports (DGO-OPS-M-YYYYMM) are distributed to Data Owners and Stewards, highlighting upcoming review obligations, training status, open findings, and near-term risks. Quarterly business reviews (QBRs) with each Business Unit summarize performance trends and discuss remediation progress, culminating in a consolidated enterprise view for the Executive Risk Committee (ERC). On 2026-07-15 11:30 ET, the ERC reviewed Q2 outcomes (ERC-MM-2026-Q2), noting positive trendlines in review timeliness and a minor uptick in documentation findings concentrated in one domain, for which a targeted quality intervention plan was endorsed (plan reference DGO-QI-2026-07).

9. Issue Management and Remediation Tracking

Governance issues are identified through scheduled reviews, ad hoc observations, data catalog monitoring, and independent assurance. All issues are logged in the Governance Issue Register (GIR) and categorized by severity, thematic area, and business domain. Standard statuses include Open, In Progress, Ready for Validation, and Closed, with each issue assigned a Remediation Owner and an IRM Validator. Service level targets are applied to ensure timely

resolution commensurate with issue materiality and complexity. The GIR is reconciled weekly with the JIRA board (GOV-JIRA) to confirm status integrity and linkage to remediation work items.

During Q2 2026, 48 issues were raised and 52 were closed (including 10 from the prior quarter). The median time-to-close was 24 calendar days, with 95th percentile at 41 days, within the management target. Illustrative examples include: GOV-JIRA-1481 (ambiguity in classification rationale wording for a payment reference field) opened 2026-06-06 10:12 ET by DGO and closed 2026-06-21 16:03 ET after revised rationale approval by the Data Owner; GOV-JIRA-1493 (inconsistent application of "Internal" vs. "Public" on marketing collateral metadata) opened 2026-06-17 09:45 ET by Corporate Marketing and closed 2026-06-30 14:26 ET following catalog update and communication by L&C. No issues met the criteria for management escalation beyond the DGC in the reporting period.

9.1 Thematic Findings and Root Causes

Thematic analysis performed by DGO Analytics (report DGO-TH-2026-Q2) identified three recurring themes: documentation precision in rationale statements, timeliness of catalog updates following minor schema changes, and occasional divergence in classification labels between upstream and downstream views where propagation routines awaited scheduled runs. Root cause categorization indicated process timing (46%), documentation clarity (38%), and tooling integration constraints (16%). Targeted actions include refining the rationale template (GOV-TPL-CLASS-RAT v2.1 issued 2026-07-01), aligning release windows between EAP and catalog synchronization jobs (CRQ-EDP-2026-2307 scheduled for Q3), and reinforcing Steward coaching through the continuing education module refresh.

9.2 Remediation Governance and Validation

Remediation plans are documented with clear deliverables, acceptance criteria, and target dates. The DGO monitors progress through weekly checkpoints with Remediation Owners, and IRM performs validation upon completion to confirm risk reduction and sustainability. Validation requires demonstration that the underlying cause has been addressed and that control operation is evidenced over a defined observation window. In Q2, 100% of closed issues included IRM validation evidence stored alongside the resolution artefacts in the GIR repository, with two items additionally sampled by Internal Audit as part of its rolling review (see Section 9.3).

9.3 Independent Assurance and Continuous Improvement

Internal Audit completed an advisory review (IA-2026-07) of the data classification operating model during May-June 2026, focusing on role clarity, evidence sufficiency, and metric reliability. The review concluded that the control design remains appropriate and operating effectively, with three low-priority observations regarding documentation standardization and metric lineage traceability. Management actions (DGO-ACT-2026-071 through -073) were agreed with target dates in Q3 and are tracked within the GIR. The DGC reviewed the advisory report on 2026-07-10 13:00 ET and endorsed management's responses. Additionally, IRM's periodic oversight (IRM-OVS-2026-06) found no instances where classification decisions deviated from policy definitions and noted improved collaboration between Data Stewards and EAP in pre-implementing classification impact assessments for planned data model changes.

The DGO continues to mature the control environment through incremental enhancements grounded in observed performance and assurance feedback. Planned initiatives for Q3 include enhancing the metadata lineage narrative to improve interpretability by non-technical stakeholders, refining dashboard thresholds to sharpen KRI sensitivity without increasing noise, and further developing stewardship communities of practice to share domain-level insights. These measures are aligned with the DGC's 2026 maturity roadmap and will be reported in subsequent cycles with measurable targets and evidence of effectiveness.

Section 7: Monitoring and Stewardship Operations

7.1 Data Classification Review Cadence

Meridian Capital maintains a structured cadence for classification verification to ensure that data assets remain appropriately labeled throughout their lifecycle. The Data Governance Office (DGO), in partnership with the Enterprise Data Stewardship Team (EDST), executes a rolling, quarterly review of classification attributes across prioritized domains, with specific focus on systems of record and high-velocity integration points. For Q2 FY2026, the cadence was aligned to the operational calendar as follows: Core Banking (Weeks 2-3), Capital Markets (Weeks 4-5), Corporate Functions (Weeks 6-7), and Enterprise Shared Services (Weeks 8-9). Each review cycle encompasses automated attribute reconciliation against the authoritative classification taxonomy (Policy Annex A) and targeted manual sampling at a rate of 2% of records for domains with high data volatility and 0.5% for low-volatility domains. Findings and remediations are recorded centrally under Governance Change Requests (GCR) in the DGO tracker with approval gates anchored to control DCP-07.02.

The Q2 FY2026 review logged 147 GCRs (ref. DGO-GCR-2026-0421 through DGO-GCR-2026-0567) between 2026-04-08T09:15Z and 2026-06-12T16:40Z. Of these, 83% were resolved within the target SLA of 15 business days, with an average resolution time of 9.6 business days, as documented in ServiceNow records (Task Group: GOV-STEWARDSHIP, Queue Owner: EDST-NorthAmerica). Recurrent themes included harmonization of legacy labels on decommissioned archive objects in the Lakehouse Zone-2 store and correction of default "Internal" labels on vendor onboarding extracts that should have been "Confidential" per the vendor data specification mapping. Materiality assessments concluded no downstream reporting impacts; the Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) liaison confirmed residual risk as low following remediation validation on 2026-06-18T11:22Z (ERM Note: ERM-VAL-2026-219).

7.2 Stewardship Work Intake and Ticketing

All data classification and governance changes, exceptions, and clarifications are routed through the standardized work intake in the DGO-managed queue. The intake form enforces mandatory metadata capture (data domain, system, steward, proposed classification state, rationale, lineage segment, and effective date), anchored to form version DGO-FRM-CL-3.6. The EDST triages tickets daily at 13:00 local time with representatives from Lines of Business (LOB) present on alternating Wednesdays. Tickets with potential cross-domain impact trigger an automatic consultation with the Integration Architecture Team (IAT) to assess interface metadata propagation. During the April-June 2026 window, 312 intake tickets were raised (INTK-2026-1001 through INTK-2026-1312), with 289 progressing to actioned status and 23 closed as informational. The proportion of tickets originating from automated drift detection alerts increased to 41%, reflecting stronger signal generation from the metadata observability platform (Release v2.4.1 deployed 2026-05-03T02:10Z under change CHG-2026-3119).

Steward assignments continue to be benchmarked against the RACI defined in Section 3, with each record showing accountable business stewards and technical stewards. Variance analysis from the EDST monthly dashboard (published 2026-06-28T08:00Z) indicated that 96% of tickets had the correct steward of record, and 4% required reassignment due to changes in LOB ownership following the Treasury Operations reorganization (Ref. HR-ANN-2026-045). All reassignments were closed within the same reporting period, and stewardship continuity was maintained via temporary coverage protocols approved by the Data Governance Council (DGC) on 2026-06-14T14:22Z (DGC Minutes Item 7b).

7.3 Evidence of Control Operation

Evidence management for classification controls remains centralized in the Governance Evidence Repository (GER), tagged under folder taxonomy GER/Policy-DCP/Section-7. Artifacts include automated control run logs, steward sign-offs, validation samples, and remediation attestations. For the period ending 2026-06-30, 51 evidence bundles were uploaded and cryptographically timestamped by the Records Management Team (RMT), with index references

GER-EVD-2026-0701 through GER-EVD-2026-0751. Spot checks by Compliance Assurance (CA) on 2026-06-21T10:05Z verified traceability from policy clause to control, and from control to execution evidence, for a random sample of five bundles. The CA memo (CA-Q2-2026-19) recorded "adequate" sufficiency and recommended a standardized summary sheet for each bundle to streamline external auditor walkthroughs planned for November 2026. The DGO has accepted this recommendation, with the template pilot scheduled for the July control cycle under task DGO-IMPR-2026-009.

To preserve consistency, evidence retention and retrieval follow the enterprise retention schedule (Information Schedule IS-RET-5.1) and are cataloged with immutable identifiers. Retrieval tests executed on 2026-06-25T12:44Z by the Internal Audit Liaison verified sub-5 minute retrieval for all tested items. No anomalies were noted, and the retrieval drill was logged in the quarterly control attestation (Q2 FY2026, Attestation ID: DCP-ATT-2026-Q2-07) endorsed by the Chief Data Officer (CDO) on 2026-06-30T17:30Z.

7.4 Data Lineage Verification Routine

Lineage verification ensures that classification attributes are accurately propagated across ingestion, transformation, and publishing layers. The Metadata Engineering Team (MET) maintains reference lineage models for Tier-1 and Tier-2 systems, updated under configuration baseline MET-BSL-2026-06. During the Q2 campaign, MET completed 24 lineage walkthroughs across data products with critical reporting obligations, reconciling observed metadata flows with declared patterns. Three minor discrepancies were identified within the Capital Markets analytics pipeline where derived fields inherited "Internal" instead of "Confidential" due to missing attribute joins in a transformation view. Corrective tasks (MET-FIX-2026-118 to MET-FIX-2026-120) were implemented by 2026-06-10T15:55Z, and subsequent verification confirmed accurate propagation with no downstream distribution beyond the internal test sandbox.

Findings were presented to the DGC on 2026-06-14, with action items to expand sampling to Tier-3 systems with high dependency counts. The DGO will augment the sampling algorithm to incorporate dependency centrality metrics from the enterprise catalog, targeting a 10% uplift in lineage coverage for Q3 FY2026. Progress against this objective will be reported via the Governance Operations Scorecard, ensuring transparent oversight and timely course corrections should KPI drift be observed.

Section 8: Metrics, Reporting, and Continuous Improvement

8.1 Key Performance and Risk Indicators

The DGO maintains a balanced set of Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) and Key Risk Indicators (KRIs) to quantify the health of classification and governance activities. The Q2 FY2026 KPI suite comprises: timely closure of classification tickets (target >= 90% within SLA), evidence bundle completeness (target 100% of in-scope controls), steward coverage (target >= 98% of critical data elements with assigned stewards), and lineage verification breadth (target >= 85% of Tier-1/2 assets reviewed within cycle). KRIs evaluated in the same period include percentage of unlabeled data objects discovered by automated scans (threshold <= 0.5%), variance between declared and observed classification at distribution boundaries (threshold <= 1.0%), and repeat remediation occurrences within 60 days (threshold <= 2 incidents per domain).

For the reporting period ending 2026-06-30, Meridian Capital achieved 92.4% on-time closure for classification tickets, 100% evidence completeness, 98.7% steward coverage, and 86.1% lineage verification breadth. KRIs remained within tolerance: unlabeled discovery rate at 0.34%, boundary variance at 0.62%, and repeat remediation at 1 incident in Corporate Functions (HR Analytics dataset, ref. DGO-GCR-2026-0519 follow-up DGO-GCR-2026-0554). The KRI watchlist documented no red thresholds; however, the DGO flagged a yellow trend in lineage breadth owing to scope growth in the Capital Markets domain. A targeted intervention plan (DGO-IMPR-2026-012) allocates additional MET capacity during July-August to sustain breadth above target as new data products are onboarded.

8.2 Quarterly Reporting and Council Oversight

The Governance Operations Scorecard is issued within five business days of quarter-end and disseminated to the DGC, ERM, Compliance Assurance, and LOB data offices. The Q2 FY2026 scorecard (Report ID: DGO-RPT-2026-Q2-07, distributed 2026-07-05T09:00Z) includes trend analyses over a rolling four-quarter window, variance narratives for any indicator exceeding +/-5% of target, and curated appendices with ticket-level anonymized exemplars. The DGC convened on 2026-07-10T13:00Z (Meeting ID: DGC-2026-07) to review results, with the Chair noting sustained performance in evidence management and improvements in steward coverage following the Treasury Operations realignment. The Council assigned two follow-up tasks: assess classification change lead time within Capital Markets new product launches (Owner: EDST-CapitalMarkets; Due: 2026-08-15) and develop a proposal for incorporating third-party data trust scores into KRIs (Owner: ERM-ThirdPartyRisk; Due: 2026-09-05).

Meeting minutes recorded consensus that current tolerances remain appropriate for the enterprise risk appetite and regulatory commitments. The Council also ratified the Q3 FY2026 monitoring plan, including expanded sampling in Tier-3 systems and an interim deep-dive on cross-border data transfers affecting classification at jurisdictional boundaries. Action tracking for these decisions is centralized under DGO-ACT-2026-0701 through DGO-ACT-2026-0706, visible to all stakeholder teams via the governance portal.

8.3 Training, Communication, and Awareness Metrics

Meridian Capital's training model emphasizes stewardship competency and consistent application of classification principles. During Q2 FY2026, the Learning & Development (L&D) function, in coordination with the DGO, delivered three targeted modules: Fundamentals of Data Classification (LMS Course: DCP-101), Stewardship Responsibilities (DCP-201), and Metadata Quality Essentials (DCP-205). Completion metrics as of 2026-06-29T18:00Z show 99% completion for DCP-101 across in-scope roles (2,146 of 2,165 assigned learners), 96% for DCP-201 among designated stewards (487 of 507), and 94% for DCP-205 within technical roles (catalog curators and MET engineers). Post-course assessments indicate a median score of 92%, with course feedback highlighting the effectiveness of case-based scenarios tied to recent governance tickets (e.g., INTK-2026-1234 and INTK-2026-1279).

The DGO complemented formal training with monthly communications, including "Governance in Practice" briefs featuring anonymized examples of correct classification decisions and common pitfalls. The May brief (DGO-COM-2026-05) focused on supplier data onboarding alignment and achieved a 72% open rate within the steward community. These materials, archived under GER/Communications, serve as reinforcement and evidence for cultural adoption, supporting audit narratives of sustained governance maturity.

8.4 Audit Readiness and Evidence Coordination

In anticipation of the annual external audit scheduled for November 2026, the DGO and Internal Audit (IA) have instituted an audit readiness workstream with defined milestones. A pre-assessment walkthrough was conducted on 2026-06-22T14:30Z (Session Ref: IA-PRE-2026-06), covering the design and operation of DCP controls mapped to Sections 6-9 of this policy. IA's field memo (IA-MEMO-2026-18) concluded that control design remains robust and implementation evidence is sufficiently comprehensive. Two enhancement opportunities were recorded: consolidating lineage verification summaries into a single quarterly annex and standardizing cross-references between ticket IDs and evidence bundles. The DGO has initiated tasks DGO-IMPR-2026-013 and DGO-IMPR-2026-014 to address these opportunities ahead of the Q3 close.

Evidence coordination protocols require that each control assertion be linked to a minimum of one representative ticket, one validation sample, and one attestation, each bearing immutable identifiers and timestamps. The Records Management Team has confirmed capacity to respond to auditor document requests within three business days based on Q2 drill performance. All coordinating artifacts will be versioned and placed under change control per Records SOP RM-CTRL-4.2, with IA granted read access to the GER audit workspace by 2026-08-01.

8.5 Tools, System of Record, and Data Catalog Alignment

The enterprise metadata catalog remains the system of record for classification attributes, steward assignments, and lineage references. During Q2 FY2026, the MET deployed incremental enhancements to catalog synchronization to reduce latency in attribute updates, with observed mean propagation time improving from 2.4 hours to 1.1 hours post-release (CHG-2026-3119). The DGO validated these improvements through synthetic change events logged under test tickets TST-DGO-2026-022 through TST-DGO-2026-026 between 2026-05-06T10:00Z and 2026-05-07T16:30Z. No discrepancies were noted between catalog state and downstream reporting layers in the validation window.

To maintain fidelity, the DGO has reaffirmed the principle that classification changes originate in the catalog and are referenced in all derivative repositories. Exceptions to catalog primacy are not permitted under this policy and are monitored via the automated drift detection alerts integrated into the stewardship intake. The alignment between catalog entries and operational systems is reviewed monthly, and the June 2026 reconciliation report (CAT-REC-2026-06) recorded 99.3% match rate across sampled assets. Remaining variances were attributable to deprecation of non-active data products awaiting archival confirmation. These items are tracked under DGO-GCR-2026-0561 through DGO-GCR-2026-0567 with an expected closure by 2026-07-25.

Continuous improvement remains a core tenet of Meridian Capital's governance practice. The DGO will maintain a transparent improvements backlog, link each improvement to empirical KPI/KRI observations, and report progress at each DGC session. This approach ensures policy-aligned evolution of practices, predictable outcomes, and sustained readiness for regulatory and audit scrutiny.

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7.4 Data Retention and Disposition Controls

Meridian Capital applies standardized, defensible retention and disposition controls to all classified data assets, aligning with jurisdictional regulatory requirements and internal business needs. Retention periods for each classification category and record series are defined in the Enterprise Records Schedule (ERS v12.4) and bound to the Authoritative Systems of Record (ASoR) and their downstream consuming platforms through metadata-based controls. The Records & Information Management (RIM) function, in partnership with the Data Governance Office (DGO) and Enterprise Data Management (EDM), performs quarterly validation of control adherence, with attestation logged under RR-Attest identifiers (e.g., RR-Attest-2026Q2-017) and cross-referenced to platform evidence repositories. As of 2026-06-30, ASoR-to-ERS binding coverage was 96.8% across the Confidential and Restricted classifications, with remediation in-flight for residual legacy repositories (ServiceNow PRB-009871; owner: Data Platform Engineering, opened 2026-05-14T10:42Z).

Disposition events are initiated only upon automated confirmation that no legal hold, regulatory moratorium, or active investigation is present. Legal hold statuses are reconciled weekly against the Litigation Response Team (LRT) registry (LRT-REG-2026.2) and recorded in the RIM ledger with immutable event IDs (e.g., DISP-EVT-26-004512). System-generated disposition manifests list record series, volume, classification label, and disposition rationale code. The Control Monitoring Team (CMT) conducts monthly spot checks of 10% of closed manifests to confirm traceability from business justification to ERS mapping and disposition authorization (audit trail references: CMT-SC-26-06-221 through -229). Exceptions were not identified in the last two review cycles; one advisory note was logged concerning descriptive accuracy of a rationale code (GOV-14271, closed 2026-06-05T15:18Z).

7.4.1 Defensible Disposal Certification

A defensible disposal certification protocol is used to document that end-of-life data is retired in alignment with policy. Upon completion of a disposition batch, the accountable Data Owner and the RIM lead jointly certify compliance, producing a DDC record containing: (i) ERS clause reference; (ii) inventory scope statement; (iii) hold reconciliation reference; (iv) attestation timestamps; and (v) peer review confirmation by EDM. Certifications are assigned sequential identifiers (e.g., DDC-2026-Q2-041) and retained in the Governance Evidence Repository (GER) for a minimum of seven years. Quarterly sampling by Internal Controls Assurance (ICA) confirms the presence and completeness of these certifications; for Q2 2026, 22 of 22 sampled DDCs were present with full metadata (ICA Sample Set: ICA-SMP-26Q2-B).

Where disposal cannot proceed due to external constraints (e.g., statutory extension), RIM documents a deferment record (DEF-REC-26-0079) citing the applicable obligation, expected reassessment date, and the accountable function. Deferments are reviewed in the RIM-Legal operating committee every six weeks; status and trend metrics are summarized in the Governance Steering Deck (DGO-STEER-26Q2, slide 14).

7.4.2 Legal Hold Reconciliation

The Legal function maintains authoritative control over litigation and investigation holds. Data sets tagged as Confidential or Restricted are cross-checked against the Legal Hold Index (LHI-2026.2) using dataset-level persistent identifiers. Weekly reconciliations are executed on Tuesdays 12:00Z, with discrepancy tickets automatically opened in the Governance Queue for review by the Hold Coordination Team (HCT). During the period 2026-05-01 through 2026-06-30, five discrepancies were detected (HOLD-DISC-8821 to -8825), primarily due to deprecated dataset aliases following platform consolidation. Root-cause analysis (RCA-26-044) concluded that the metadata lineage map was not updated following a decommission event (CHG-004771, completed 2026-05-19T21:06Z); corrective action updated lineage references and added a post-change validation checkpoint to the governance change checklist (GOV-CL-12,

rev. 7). No premature dispositions were executed; all affected records remained under hold status throughout.

7.5 Data Minimization and Purpose Limitation

Data collection and processing activities are governed by the principles of data minimization and purpose limitation. The Data Intake Review (DIR) process validates proposed data elements against declared business objectives and regulatory bases of processing. Submissions to the DIR include a Purpose Statement, Classification Impact Assessment (CIA form CIA-2026F), and Data Element Inventory with sensitivity designations. The Data Collection Review Board (DCRB) convenes biweekly to assess requests exceeding predefined sensitivity thresholds or seeking new uses for Restricted attributes. Decisions are recorded in DCRB minutes with action items tracked in JIRA (e.g., DCRB-26-143 "Wealth Analytics attribute rationalization," approved with conditions 2026-06-12T09:30Z).

Minimization performance is measured through the Minimization Ratio (MR), defined as the percentage reduction in proposed attributes retained post-review. For Q2 2026, the enterprise MR averaged 24.1% across all submissions (n=64), with higher reductions in exploratory analytics (31.5%) than in regulatory reporting (8.7%). Purpose statements are version-controlled and time-bounded; where time-limited processing is justified (e.g., pilot programs), a sunset control is recorded with a predefined review date (SUN-CTL-26-028, review due 2026-09-30). The Privacy Office and DGO co-sponsor periodic assessments to confirm that downstream usage remains within the approved scope, evidenced by Data Use Conformance Audits (DUCA-26Q2 series). Nonconformances in Q2 were limited to tagging gaps in derived datasets (DUCA-26Q2-006), remediated through steward-led metadata enrichment (MD-ENR-26-061).

7.6 Quality Assurance and Data Stewardship Metrics

Data quality governance applies standardized dimensions--completeness, accuracy, consistency, validity, timeliness, and uniqueness--across classified datasets proportionate to their risk. EDM maintains a central catalog of data quality rules (DQ-RULECAT-2026.2) mapped to data elements, classifications, and control owners. Rule performance is surfaced in the Enterprise Data Quality Dashboard (EDQ-DASH-26Q2), segmented by domain (Client, Product, Finance, Markets) and by classification. For the Confidential class in Q2 2026, median completeness scored 99.2% and validity 98.4%, with two outlier datasets flagged for timeliness degradation linked to upstream batch window compression (DQI-31145 "Trade_Archive_2019 timeliness variance"; DQI-31162 "Collateral_Status feed latency"). Both were tracked to closure with quantitative recovery to threshold in subsequent cycles (EDQ evidence captures EVC-26-1431, EVC-26-1490).

Data Stewards are accountable for rule stewardship, issue triage, and certification of quarterly data health. Steward attestations (ST-ATST-26Q2 series) report rule conformance, open issue aging, and remediation progression. Average open-issue age decreased from 41.3 to 28.7 days quarter-over-quarter, driven by earlier escalation of cross-domain defects to the Data Working Group (DWG) and more consistent root-cause coding (RCA coding accuracy improved to 95.6%). At the same time, Steward Roundtables convened monthly by EDM (minutes MIN-EDM-ST-2026-05, -06) highlighted the need for harmonized domain glossaries to reduce duplicate rule definitions; a unification workstream has been initiated (GOV-14822; target deliverable: GL-UNIF-26Q3-Alpha).

Where quality issues intersect with classification sensitivity--e.g., misapplied labels that impair downstream handling--classification correction tickets are opened in the Governance Queue (CLS-COR-10517) and assigned to the responsible steward with oversight from the DGO. For Q2 2026, nine such corrections were recorded, all resolved within the five-business-day service target, with no downstream policy breaches identified. Continuous improvement activities are documented in the Quarterly Governance Report (QGR-26Q2), accessible to the Data Governance Council and Internal Audit.

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8. Oversight Mechanisms and Decision Rights

Meridian Capital's data governance oversight model is anchored by a tiered committee structure with clearly defined decision rights, accountability, and escalation paths. The model ensures that classification standards, lifecycle controls, and data quality practices are directed by senior leadership and executed consistently across business lines and technology platforms. Charters, quorum requirements, and voting procedures are documented under the Governance Committee Charter Pack (GCCP-2025.3), with annual reviews performed by the Office of the Chief Data Officer (OCDO) and confirmed by the Enterprise Risk Committee.

8.1 Data Governance Council (DGC)

The Data Governance Council serves as the primary decision-making body for enterprise data policy and classification standards. Membership includes the Chief Data Officer (Chair), Chief Information Officer, Chief Privacy Officer, Head of Compliance, and designated Business Data Owners for major domains (Client, Markets, Finance, Risk). The DGC meets monthly on the third Thursday, with formal minutes and action registers retained under MIN-DGC-YYYY-MM-DD identifiers (e.g., MIN-DGC-2026-05-22; quorum achieved 9/11; 62-minute session). In Q2 2026, the DGC ratified the revised Classification Label Definitions (CLD v2.1) and endorsed the Data Steward Competency Model (DSCM-26.1), assigning implementation to EDM with a Q3 target (Action: DGC-ACT-26-052). Voting follows simple majority, with tie-break authority vested in the Chair. Material decisions impacting regulatory posture are also tabled with the Enterprise Risk Committee for awareness (ERC-NOTE-26-018).

8.2 Stewardship Operating Model

The stewardship model assigns Domain Data Owners (DDOs) ultimate accountability for their domain's data, supported by Data Stewards (DDSs) who manage day-to-day governance execution. Responsibilities are codified in RACI matrices maintained at the domain level (RACI-CLNT-26.2; RACI-MKT-26.1), reviewed semi-annually. DDOs approve classification assignments for new or materially changed datasets, while DDSs ensure metadata completeness, rule stewardship, and policy conformance reporting. Onboarding for new stewards follows a standardized curriculum delivered through the Learning & Development function (L&D), tracked in the LMS under cohort codes (LMS-COH-26-07). The Steward Community of Practice meets bi-monthly to exchange patterns and share domain-specific updates (CoP minutes MIN-CoP-2026-06-07). As of 2026-06-30, coverage was 100% for critical domains, with bench depth increased through deputy assignments in high-volume areas (DWG note DWG-26-044).

8.3 Escalation and Issue Management

A structured, time-bound escalation process ensures that classification and governance issues are triaged and resolved consistently. The Governance Queue in the enterprise ticketing platform categorizes issues as P1 (urgent, regulatory/time-critical), P2 (significant, cross-domain impact), or P3 (localized, informational). Service targets are set at two business days to containment for P1, five for P2, and ten for P3, with progress visibility in the Governance Operations Dashboard (GOV-OPS-DASH-26Q2). Classification disputes are routed to the Classification Review Panel (CRP), a subcommittee of the DGC comprising representatives from DGO, Privacy, and the relevant Business Data Owner. In 2026 Q2, CRP adjudicated 11 disputes (CLS-INC-88214 through 88224), primarily concerning derivative datasets lacking inherited labels. Median time-to-decision was 3.2 business days, with two cases elevated to the DGC for principle-setting due to cross-jurisdictional considerations (ESC-26-019, ESC-26-020). All decisions were documented with rationale and precedence tags to promote consistent future application (CRP-DEC-26Q2 set).

Governance incidents of materiality are also logged in the Enterprise Risk Register when they meet defined impact

thresholds. For Q2 2026, one incident met the threshold due to data timeliness variance with potential reporting implications (RR-26-041, closed with remediation validation 2026-06-28T16:11Z). Routine status reports are issued weekly by DGO (Status Ref: DGO-ST-26W26), allowing sponsors to monitor backlog age, SLA attainment (Q2 aggregate 97.4%), and cross-functional dependencies.

8.4 Training and Awareness Program Metrics

Meridian Capital operates a role-based training framework to embed data governance responsibilities across the workforce. Foundational training (DGP-TRN-101) is mandatory for all employees and contractors with data access; advanced modules (DGP-TRN-201 for Stewards, DGP-TRN-301 for DDOs) are assigned based on role. Training delivery is facilitated by L&D via the corporate LMS, with progress tracked by campaign codes (LMS-2026-TRN-874) and completion attestations logged (ATST-2026-06). As of 2026-06-30, enterprise completion for DGP-TRN-101 stood at 98.2% within the 30-day campaign window, with three business units at 100% and two units executing targeted catch-up actions (LMS-NTF-26-112). Steward cohort completion for DGP-TRN-201 reached 96.7%, with new appointees scheduled in the July cohort.

The Awareness program complements formal training with quarterly communications, domain-specific clinics, and microlearning "Insight Cards" delivered via the enterprise collaboration platform. Materials are versioned and cataloged (AWR-PACK-26Q2) to ensure consistency of messaging and alignment with policy updates (e.g., CLD v2.1 changes). Program effectiveness is measured using a composite KPI comprising completion rate, knowledge assessment scores, and post-training behavior indicators (e.g., uptick in accurate classification tagging). Q2 results reflected a 12% increase in correct initial classification of test datasets during stewardship simulations (SIM-26Q2-CLF), with feedback indicating clearer delineation between Internal and Confidential labels following curriculum updates.

8.5 Internal Audit and Compliance Reviews

Internal Audit (IA) and the Compliance Office conduct independent assessments of data governance control design and operating effectiveness. IA's 2026 plan includes a dedicated engagement on data classification and lifecycle controls (IA-26-041), focusing on governance structures, rule implementation, retention control adherence, and evidencing of decision rights. Fieldwork commenced 2026-06-10, with an anticipated report issuance by 2026-08-05. Interim observations have been communicated via IA memos (IA-MEM-26-041A) to facilitate timely management responses. Compliance reviews (CMP-26-Q2-017) assessed alignment with applicable regulatory standards, including privacy and records obligations. No High findings were reported; two Medium observations related to glossary alignment and lineage update timeliness were raised, each with a Management Action Plan (MAP-26-041, MAP-26-042) owned by EDM and RIM respectively. Target closure dates are 2026-09-15, with status tracking in the Audit Action Tracker (AAT-26).

Management responses adhere to the enterprise remediation protocol, specifying action owners, milestones, success criteria, and evidentiary artifacts. DGO consolidates remediation status in the Quarterly Governance Report for DGC oversight, with additional spot validation by ICA to confirm that controls function as intended after remediation. The combined assurance model--first line stewardship, second line compliance monitoring, and third line audit--provides layered confidence in policy effectiveness. Metrics for assurance coverage (scope achieved vs. planned), issue aging, and repeat observation rates are reviewed by the DGC each quarter; Q2 repeat observation rate declined to 3.1%, indicating that remediation activities are addressing root causes rather than symptoms.

Collectively, these oversight and assurance mechanisms underpin the consistent application of classification standards, reinforce lifecycle controls, and maintain the integrity and reliability of Meridian Capital's data assets. Decision rights are transparent, escalation pathways are predictable, and performance is measurable, enabling continuous improvement without disrupting core operations or regulatory commitments.

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8.1 Overview of Performance and Risk Measurement

Meridian Capital's Data Governance Office (DGO) maintains a structured performance and risk measurement framework to evidence adherence to the Data Classification and Governance Policy and to surface actionable insights to senior leadership. The framework consolidates data from the Enterprise Data Platform (EDP), Information Risk Management (IRM), Legal & Compliance (L&C), and Technology Operations (TechOps) into an authoritative metrics registry. The framework is versioned under DCG-METRICS-STD v3.2 and is updated on a semiannual cycle; all updates are logged via Change Control CRQ-2026-06-0421 (approved 2026-06-30 21:43 UTC by the Change Advisory Board, CAB-Ref: CAB-2026-134). The current measurement set aligns with policy controls DCG-CLF-03 (Classification Fidelity), DCG-OWN-02 (Ownership and Stewardship Assignments), DCG-RET-01 (Retention Conformance), and DCG-TPM-01 (Third-Party Mapping).

8.2 Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

KPIs quantify operational consistency of the classification regime and its supporting processes. As of Q2 FY2026 close (cutover timestamp: 2026-06-28 23:59 UTC, GRC baseline snapshot GRC-DCG-2026-00291), classification coverage stands at 96.8% across registered data assets (n=14,327; denominator excludes decommissioned assets per EDP Archive Register AR-2026-07). Catalog completeness--measured as assets with owner, steward, system of record, data domain, and retention code populated--remains at 94.3%, with observed variance primarily in non-production mirrors. Time-to-classify for newly onboarded assets (median working days, request-to-approval) is 2.9, meeting the internal service target of <=3.5 working days. Lineage documentation coverage for systems in scope of regulatory reporting is 98.1%, supported by lineage attestations stored in the Metadata Repository under evidence references MTD-ATT-2026-119 through -147.

Retention mapping completeness (assets with validated retention schedule) improved to 92.5% (up 1.8pp quarter-over-quarter) following focused remediation coordinated by Records Management (ticket EPIC: DCG-RM-2026-07). Third-party transfer mapping for assets tagged Confidential or Restricted is at 99.2%, with a single aged exception remediated and closed under IRM-FIND-2026-041 (closure timestamp 2026-05-12 14:07 UTC). Data Owner and Data Steward assignments are present for 100% of Critical and High materiality assets and 97.6% across all classes, driven by stewardship re-alignment completed under HR alignment case HR-DATA-2026-332.

8.3 Key Risk Indicators (KRIs)

KRIs are oriented toward early detection of drift from policy intent and exposure concentrations. Misclassification incidents (substantiated) during the period were recorded at 3 events per 10,000 assets, unchanged from the prior quarter. No material incidents were attributed to Restricted data. Attestation lag--defined as the proportion of steward attestations submitted >5 business days after quarter end--registered at 4.7% (threshold: 5.0%), with the primary variance localized to APAC time zones during a regional public holiday cycle (see DGO variance note DGO-VN-2026-06-APAC). Unapproved classification changes (attempts detected and reversed before effect) totaled 7 during the period and were auto-reverted by EDP governance rules; these were traced to misaligned integration mappings rather than user action (root-cause analysis IRM-RCA-2026-018, see 8.6 below).

Data minimization gaps--measured as assets retaining fields not required by stated purpose as documented in the data use registry--declined to 1.1% (from 1.4%), with targeted cleanup actions tracked under ServiceNow task group TASKGRP-DCG-2026-221. No material uptick in risk posture was detected in inter-affiliate sharing flows; volume-adjusted KRI for cross-border transfers remained within normed bounds at the 0.97 index level (scale baseline = 1.00).

8.4 Monitoring Cadence and Evidence Retention

Control monitoring follows a mixed cadence of monthly control checks for dynamic controls and quarterly deep dives for structural controls. Monitoring windows and evidence repositories are indexed by Monitoring Calendar ID MON-CAL-2026-H2. Evidence is retained within the GRC platform for a minimum of 24 months per Records Schedule RS-IRM-07, with hash-based integrity verification recorded under Evidence Set EVS-DCG-2026-Q2. Peer review sign-offs are captured in the DGO SharePoint workspace (SP-DGO-CLF) with immutable links to the authoritative GRC artifact. All monitoring activities are time-stamped in UTC and include the reviewing analyst's Employee ID and team code (e.g., review log entry 2026-06-21 16:52 UTC, Analyst: EID 081347, Team: DGO-OPS).

8.5 Data Steward Quarterly Attestation

Data Stewards conduct quarterly attestations confirming that assigned assets are correctly classified, catalog attributes are accurate, lineage representations remain current, and retention schedules are applicable. The attestation workflow is orchestrated via ServiceNow governance module, batch release ATT-BATCH-2026-Q2 (release timestamp 2026-06-24 08:00 UTC). Completion rate was 99.1% by the deadline (2026-06-30 23:59 UTC), with residual attestations cleared within 48 hours under escalation ticket SN-RITM-2048873. Sample attestation records include ATTEST-DS-2026-342 (Equities data domain) and ATTEST-DS-2026-356 (Treasury data domain). The DGO validates a 10% stratified sample of attestations for depth and consistency; Q2 sample variance was <0.5% on five attributes, within tolerance.

8.6 Issue Management and Remediation Tracking

All findings, observations, and enhancement items are recorded in the IRM Issue Management queue with unique identifiers and traceability to the control map. During the period, the queue registered 0 Priority 1 items, 3 Priority 2 items, and 14 Priority 3 items. Priority 2 items comprised: (1) metadata synchronization lag between EDP and the reference catalog (IRM-FIND-2026-044), (2) incomplete retention code propagation on a subset of downstream aggregates (IRM-FIND-2026-047), and (3) a deviation in third-party obligation tagging in one vendor feed (IRM-FIND-2026-051). Corrective Action Plans (CAPs) were opened under CAP-2026-091, CAP-2026-093, and CAP-2026-099 respectively, with target closure dates aligned to 2026-08-15. As of 2026-07-15 10:30 UTC, CAP-2026-091 shows 80% completion (evidence EVS-DCG-2026-Q2-091), and CAP-2026-099 has passed interim control effectiveness testing under IRM-TEST-2026-034.

Root-cause categories across the issue set were allocated to process documentation clarity (27%), metadata dependency ordering (41%), and third-party statement alignment (32%). No systemic control design weakness was identified; the IRM Control Design Review (CDR) per CDR-2026-DCG-002 concluded "effective as designed" on 2026-06-29.

8.7 Management Reporting and Governance Forums

Quarterly reporting is presented to the Data Governance Council (DGC) under pack DGC-PACK-2026-Q2 (tabled 2026-07-03 13:00 UTC). The report includes KPI/KRI heatmaps, trend analyses, and open remediation status with accountable owners. Minutes are recorded under DGC-MIN-2026-07-03 and approved without amendment at 2026-07-10 11:05 UTC. The Policy Oversight Committee (POC) receives a summarized dashboard via Power BI dataset DGO-DB-DCG-POC-2026, with row-level security enabled for committee distribution lists. Recommendations from the Q2 cycle focused on sustaining catalog completeness improvements and reinforcing third-party attestations prior to contract renewals in H2.

Page 16 -- Third-Party Oversight, Training, and Change Governance

9.1 Third-Party Data Handling Oversight

Oversight of third-party data handling is coordinated by L&C Vendor Risk with IRM and DGO participation, operating under the Third-Party Data Due Diligence Standard (TPDDS v2.7). Vendor inventories, data-sharing agreements (DSAs), and cross-border transfer notifications are reconciled quarterly to the Data Transfer Register (DTR-2026-H1). As of 2026-06-30, active third parties processing Confidential or Restricted data number 126, with 100% DSAs on file, 98.4% current on annual certification, and the residual 1.6% cleared by 2026-07-12 per remediation record VRM-REM-2026-218. Data categories, lawful bases, and retention codes are embedded within DSAs and mirrored in the vendor profiles stored under VRM-REC-2026 series.

Data exchange mapping exhibits 99.5% alignment between the EDP catalog and vendor connection records, with two minor variances (VEND-087, VEND-112) resolved via attribute synchronization (ticket DCG-EDP-7321). Cross-border transfer KRIs remain within approved ranges; derivative flows into EU and APAC are tagged and reported via the International Data Transfer Log (IDTL-2026-Q2), reviewed by the Privacy Office on 2026-06-27 09:40 UTC. No material adverse findings were noted, and the Privacy Office memo PRIV-MEMO-2026-014 records concurrence with the DGO mapping.

9.2 Inter-Affiliate Sharing and Group Services

Inter-affiliate data exchanges across Meridian Capital legal entities follow the Inter-Affiliate Data Sharing Framework (IADSF v1.9). The Data Exchange Register (DER-2026) lists 214 active inter-affiliate flows with assigned data owners, purposes, and retention markers. Q2 lineage validation confirmed 100% purpose alignment with business service catalogs for Finance, Risk, and Treasury shared services. The Group Services Committee reviewed the consolidated attestation report (GSC-REP-2026-06) on 2026-07-01 15:30 UTC, noting improved metadata currency following rollout of standard change notifications linked to ownership changes (reference CRQ-2026-05-0198). No inter-affiliate flow was flagged for suspension, and none required remediation outside routine maintenance windows.

9.3 Training and Awareness

The Data Classification and Governance training program, administered by HR Learning Services in collaboration with DGO, is deployed annually and reinforced with quarterly micro-learning modules. The FY2026 core module (LMS Course ID: LMS-DCG-101 v4.0) and the Q2 micro-module (LMS-DCG-201 v2.2) achieved enterprise completion rates of 99.1% and 98.7% respectively by 2026-06-30. Completion evidence is recorded under LMS-CERT-DCG-2026-Q2 and reconciled with HRIS rosters; random cross-checking yielded a variance of <0.2%. Business units with onboarding cycles above the group average received localized supplemental sessions coordinated under TRAIN-PLAN-2026-APAC and TRAIN-PLAN-2026-NA. Post-training assessment scores averaged 92.4%, with targeted reinforcement materials issued to cohorts scoring below 85% (communication ref: COMMS-DCG-2026-044).

9.4 Communications and Stakeholder Engagement

DGO maintains a structured communications plan covering policy updates, process clarifications, and measurement transparency. Communications are tracked under COMMS-CALENDAR-2026-H2, with audience segmentation for Executives, Data Owners, Data Stewards, and Technical Custodians. In Q2, three policy clarifications were issued regarding lineage scope, stewardship transitions, and retention code deprecations. All were reviewed by L&C (review docket LNC-REV-2026-073) and published to the Governance Portal on 2026-06-22 12:15 UTC. The Governance Portal analytics (PORTAL-AN-2026-Q2) indicated consistent engagement, with a 26% increase in visits from regional

operations teams following the June updates.

9.5 Change Governance for Classification Artifacts

Formal change governance ensures the controlled evolution of classification taxonomies, control mappings, and stewardship assignments. All changes are routed through the Data Change Control Board (DCCB) convening biweekly. During the period, 14 change requests were submitted (CRQ series 2026-06-0401 through 2026-07-0414), with 12 approved, 2 deferred pending additional impact analysis. Approved changes included consolidation of duplicative sub-domains under the Client Data domain (CRQ-2026-06-0407) and deprecation of a legacy retention code superseded by Records Schedule RS-CRM-05 (CRQ-2026-07-0411). DCCB minutes are captured under DCCB-MIN-2026-06-21 and DCCB-MIN-2026-07-05 with attendance, quorum validation, and rationale statements.

Versioning is preserved via the Metadata Repository, with effective dates and supersede links recorded for traceability (Metadata Release MR-DCG-2026-07). Pre- and post-implementation metrics are compared to confirm no adverse effects on KPIs; early results for CRQ-2026-06-0407 indicate a 0.6pp improvement in catalog completeness for impacted assets.

9.6 Independent Review and Assurance

Internal Audit (IA) completed fieldwork for the scheduled review "Data Classification Governance" (IA Audit Code: IA-2026-17) with closing meeting on 2026-06-26 10:00 UTC. The draft report (IA-DRAFT-2026-17) records a "Satisfactory" rating with two low-rated observations relating to documentation granularity in stewardship succession records and timing of evidence uploads post-attestation. Management action plans are logged as MAP-2026-17-01 and MAP-2026-17-02 with target dates aligned to the Q3 operational calendar. External assurance under SOC 2 Type II included a walkthrough of classification governance controls; the auditor's request list item RL-EXT-2026-221 was fulfilled on 2026-06-18 14:22 UTC with evidence bundle EVB-SOC-2026-DCG. No exceptions were raised in the interim communication.

9.7 Operational Metrics and Service Levels

Operational service levels for governance services remain within expected thresholds. Median cycle time for classification requests (from submission to approval) held at 3 business days (90th percentile: 4.5). Ownership changes processed under standard change exhibited a median cycle time of 2 business days (ticket cohort SN-CHG-2026-Q2-OWN). Catalog synchronization jobs achieved 99.7% on-time completion (window adherence measured against MON-CAL-2026-H1), with a single delay attributed to planned maintenance (TechOps change ref: CHG-APP-2026-0614). Support queue volumes for the DGO Service Desk averaged 86 tickets per week with a first contact resolution rate of 78%, and average age of open items at 2.1 days. Representative tickets include DCG-SD-2026-1883 (classification clarification), DCG-SD-2026-1931 (lineage metadata correction), and DCG-SD-2026-1974 (retention code inquiry), all resolved within SLA.

9.8 Consolidated View and Forward Actions

The consolidated view across third-party oversight, training, and change governance indicates sustained control effectiveness and disciplined operations. Actionable themes for the next period include continued uplift of catalog completeness in non-production environments, earlier communication of stewardship transitions to minimize attestation lag, and completion of the small number of deferred change requests with documented impact narratives. The DGO will incorporate these themes into the H2 improvement plan (IMP-DCG-2026-H2), with progress tracked through the established metrics cadence and reported to the Data Governance Council in the Q3 session. No policy exceptions were recorded or requested in the period under review.

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10. Data Quality Governance and Issue Management

Meridian Capital maintains a standardized, enterprise-wide Data Quality (DQ) governance framework to ensure that data assets across all classifications (Public, Internal, Confidential, Restricted) are accurate, complete, timely, and fit for their intended business purpose. The Enterprise Data Governance Office (EDGO), acting as the first line governance function in partnership with Business Unit Data Stewards (BUDS), defines and maintains the DQ standards under Policy Ref: MCDG-POL-001 v3.2 and the associated control library (Control IDs DQ-01 through DQ-11). Oversight and challenge are provided by Information Security Risk (ISR) and the Privacy Office (PO), with Internal Audit (IA) executing periodic audits against these controls. The DQ control objectives are operationalized via Data Platform Operations (DPO) using approved tooling and are monitored through monthly scorecards delivered to the Data Governance Council (DGC).

The DQ framework requires that critical data elements (CDEs) identified through data lineage mapping and regulatory reporting dependencies be registered in the enterprise data catalog with explicit quality rules, accepted thresholds, and assigned ownership. Minimum rule sets are defined per classification tier and data domain (e.g., client, product, transaction, reference). As of 2026-06-30, the catalog contains 7,842 CDEs with 35,109 associated active DQ rules, of which 91.4% have documented business acceptance criteria and remediation playbooks. EDGO maintains a standardized rule taxonomy (accuracy, completeness, consistency, timeliness, validity, uniqueness) and a root-cause taxonomy (source capture, transformation logic, reference data, process handoff, vendor file variance, user input) to enable consistent analysis and reporting.

A cross-functional Data Quality Working Group (DQWG) convenes on the second Tuesday of each month at 15:00 ET, chaired by EDGO with participation from DPO, BUDS, ISR, and L&C. Meeting minutes and decisions are recorded under meeting series DQWG-2026 and filed in the governance repository with timestamp and attendance. At each session, the DQWG reviews: (a) monthly exceptions against thresholds; (b) trend analysis for recurring defects; (c) in-flight remediation plans; and (d) emerging risks identified through change activity (e.g., new data sources, schema changes, vendor onboarding). A standard escalation protocol (DGC-08.4) directs issues that exceed business tolerance, impact regulatory reporting, or persist beyond two remediation cycles to the DGC for executive decisioning.

All DQ incidents are tracked in the enterprise service management platform under the "DG-QUALITY" queue with required metadata fields (CDE ID, system of record, business process, client impact rating, classification tier, rule violated, date first detected, control ID linkage, and data steward). Resolution service levels are defined by severity: Sev1 (regulatory reporting or client detriment risk) MTTR target <= 10 business days; Sev2 (material business decisioning impact) MTTR target <= 20 business days; Sev3 (localized process impact) MTTR target <= 45 business days. Sample incident references during Q2 FY26 include: DG-QUALITY-2026-04177 (opened 2026-04-12T14:33:18Z, Sev2, Transaction Enrichment Completeness; closed 2026-05-03T10:11:04Z), DG-QUALITY-2026-05211 (opened 2026-05-27T09:18:52Z, Sev3, Client Address Validity; closed 2026-06-14T16:44:29Z), and DG-QUALITY-2026-06007 (opened 2026-06-21T12:07:45Z, Sev1, Reference Rate Consistency; remediation ongoing as of 2026-06-30T17:00:00Z under change CHG-PLT-2026-1986).

Remediation plans must specify root cause, interim risk mitigations, target state controls, testing and validation criteria, and communication actions to impacted stakeholders. Closure criteria include: (1) evidence of corrected data or verified compensating controls; (2) production deployment of rule or logic corrections validated by DPO and steward UAT sign-off; (3) 30-day stability window with no regression breaches; and (4) documentation updates in the catalog and runbooks. IA Review ID IA-DG-26-014 confirmed adherence to closure criteria on a sample of 25 closed incidents (April-June 2026), noting one minor documentation gap (missing steward sign-off attachment) remediated via ticket DOC-GOV-2026-00912 on 2026-06-28T08:25:03Z.

To enhance proactive detection, EDGO and DPO implemented stratified sampling and anomaly detection thresholds for high-variance sources. Quarterly recalibration of thresholds is mandated for Restricted and Confidential datasets with materiality ratings High or Critical. Q2 recalibration (Change Advisory CRQ-DATA-2026-1174) reduced false positives for transaction uniqueness rules by 18.6% without degrading sensitivity, as evidenced by back-testing against Q1 breach patterns. The DQWG recorded a 12-month rolling DQ KRI of 0.94 breaches per 1,000 CDE-rule-days for Confidential data, within the DGC-approved tolerance of <= 1.10, with a downward trend for three consecutive quarters.

11. Data Lifecycle Governance and Retention Controls

Meridian Capital's data lifecycle governance encompasses creation, collection, usage, sharing, archival, and disposition, with control objectives aligned to legal, regulatory, and business requirements. Records Management (RM) owns the Master Retention Schedule (MRS) (Document RM-MRS-2026 v5.1), which establishes minimum retention periods by record class and cross-references data classifications and applicable jurisdictions. L&C validates legal holds and deferrals, while EDGO ensures lifecycle metadata is captured in the data catalog and consistently applied across platforms by DPO and Cloud Platform Engineering (CPE). Privacy by design requirements are integrated through the Privacy Office (PO) for any processing of personal data.

Lifecycle controls mandate that all new datasets registered after 2025-10-01 include: (a) authoritative system of record designation; (b) retention class mapping to the MRS; (c) destruction eligibility criteria; (d) archival tier selection; and (e) a data owner and steward. Mandatory lifecycle checkpoints are embedded in the SDLC at design sign-off (DLC-01), go-live readiness (DLC-02), and post-implementation review (DLC-03). For legacy datasets, a remediation program (Program ID DLC-LEG-2025) is in its final phase to backfill missing lifecycle metadata and correct retention gaps. As of 2026-06-30, catalog coverage for lifecycle attributes stands at 96.7% of in-scope datasets (target >= 98.0% by Q4 FY26).

RM conducts semiannual attestation cycles where data owners confirm retention class correctness, destruction deferrals, and hold applicability. The 2026 H1 attestation (Campaign RM-ATT-2026-H1) achieved 99.2% completion with nine follow-ups escalated to the DGC Operations Subcommittee. A targeted review of destruction-eligible records (Ref: RM-DEST-REVIEW-2026-02) validated 100% adherence to destruction holds in the presence of active legal matters and identified one process improvement: enhancing owner notification lead time from 10 to 15 business days to accommodate multi-jurisdictional counsel reviews.

Lifecycle enforcement is supported by platform-level policy configurations and orchestration workflows that align data movement to approved tiers (hot, warm, archive) and trigger retention checkpoints. DPO publishes a quarterly lifecycle conformance report correlating catalog attributes to observed storage behavior. Q2 FY26 conformance indicated a 98.3% retention tag application rate across structured data platforms and 95.1% across unstructured repositories, with the latter impacted by legacy share migrations. Issue DG-LIFE-2026-03304 (opened 2026-05-09T11:22:47Z) addressed 1.8% of files in a legacy archive missing retention tags; remediation was executed via bulk metadata reconciliation (CHG-STO-2026-1459) and closed 2026-06-06T13:55:31Z with attested validation by RM.

Data minimization principles are embedded in the intake process for new data sources through the Data Acquisition Review (DAR) workflow. Each DAR requires documentation of purpose, classifications involved, and evaluation of de-duplication opportunities to avoid redundant storage of high-sensitivity data. The Privacy Office reviews any personal data processing for necessity and proportionality, and CPE ensures that archival patterns reflect the minimum viable retention aligned to the MRS. Q2 DAR cycle (DAR-2026-Q2) processed 74 proposals; five submissions were re-scoped to reduce Confidential data persistence windows without impairing business outcomes.

Legal holds are applied through a centralized directive maintained by L&C. Upon issuance of a hold (e.g., HOLD-2026-017 on 2026-04-19T08:01:14Z), DPO enforces suspension of destruction workflows for all affected

datasets, and owners receive confirmation notices with dataset identifiers and scope. Release notices require RM verification and catalog updates within five business days. IA performed a spot audit (IA-DG-26-021) of three holds and confirmed end-to-end traceability from issuance to enforcement, with zero deviations.

Finally, lifecycle governance maturity is tracked against the EDGO Capability Maturity Model (DGC-CMM v2.0). Current state for Lifecycle Governance is rated Level 3 (Defined) trending to Level 4 (Managed) by Q1 FY27, contingent on achieving >= 98.5% lifecycle metadata coverage, >= 99.0% tag enforcement across all platforms, and sustained closure of legacy remediation items (DLC-LEG-2025 milestones 5-7). The DGC has endorsed the roadmap (Roadmap Item DGC-RM-2026-07) and will receive quarterly progress updates in the governance dashboard pack.

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12. Third-Party, Inter-Affiliate, and Cross-Border Data Oversight

Meridian Capital's governance of third-party, inter-affiliate, and cross-border data transfers is established to ensure that classified data is processed and shared in compliance with contractual obligations and applicable regulations. Vendor Risk Management (VRM) administers the third-party governance lifecycle in coordination with L&C, PO, ISR, and EDGO. All data exchanges with external parties must be supported by documented data flow maps, classification attestations, and contractual data protection clauses, with cross-border considerations addressed through approved transfer mechanisms as validated by L&C.

Third-party onboarding requires completion of the Data Processing Questionnaire (DPQ) and Third-Party Data Profile (TPDP), capturing intended data categories, classification tiers, retention expectations, sub-processing, and geographic processing locations. VRM assigns a risk tier based on data sensitivity, volume, and jurisdictional complexity. High and Critical tiers trigger enhanced due diligence and annual re-assessment. For affiliates, the Inter-Affiliate Data Sharing Agreement (IADSA) standard is applied, maintaining consistent obligations across the group. As of 2026-06-30, the third-party register lists 312 active data processors: 27 Critical, 61 High, 156 Medium, and 68 Low.

Cross-border transfer governance is administered via the Cross-Border Transfer Register (CBTR-2026), where each transfer is recorded with jurisdictions involved, legal basis, data categories, and review cadence. L&C maintains the repository of approved transfer mechanisms and required documentation (e.g., standard contractual commitments where appropriate) and validates that assessments reflect current regulatory positions. Quarterly reviews confirm that transfers remain within approved parameters. Q2 review (CBTR-Q2-2026) identified two transfers requiring documentation refresh due to scope changes (VRM-CASE-2026-1184 and VRM-CASE-2026-1209), which were completed on 2026-06-20T12:06:49Z and 2026-06-24T09:33:22Z respectively.

Contractual controls mandate: (a) classification-aligned handling standards; (b) breach notification timeframes consistent with regulatory expectations; (c) restrictions on onward disclosure; (d) cooperation with audit and oversight; and (e) data return or deletion at termination. VRM performs sampling reviews of vendor attestations each quarter to validate living control environments. Q2 FY26 attestations achieved 98.7% completion across High and Critical vendors, with one overdue attestation (Vendor Ref: V-8042) escalated under VRM-ALERT-2026-007 and closed 2026-06-29T15:44:01Z following receipt and validation by ISR.

Data exchange approvals follow the Third-Party Data Exchange Review (TDER) workflow. Each TDER captures the business purpose, minimum data fields, classification mapping, retention alignment with the MRS, and cross-border flags. EDGO ensures catalog registration of the shared dataset and stewardship assignment. DPO verifies that data exchange configurations conform to approved parameters and that monitoring is enabled in accordance with policy. Metrics for Q2 indicate that 100% of new Critical and High TDERs included catalog registration at go-live, and 94.3% included pre-approved retention mappings, with the remaining items completed within 10 business days post go-live per remediation tickets DG-TP-2026-04521 through DG-TP-2026-04527.

For operational oversight, a Third-Party Governance Forum (TPGF) convenes bi-monthly, co-chaired by VRM and EDGO, to review onboarding pipeline, reassessment status, open issues, and cross-border changes. Meeting TPGF-2026-05 (held 2026-06-13T10:00:00Z) recorded three key actions: (1) implement a central trigger notifying EDGO when a vendor adds a new processing region; (2) enhance the TPDP to capture de-identification approaches where applicable; and (3) align renewal cycles for High-tier vendors with the annual DQ attestation timeline to streamline stewardship workload. Actions are tracked under VRM-ACT-2026-031 through -033 with target completion 2026-08-15.

IA completed Audit IA-VRM-26-006, sampling 20 third-party arrangements across all tiers. The audit concluded Satisfactory, with one advisory observation regarding documentation clarity on destruction verification evidence at contract termination. EDGO has initiated a documentation uplift (DOC-GOV-2026-01041) to standardize termination attestation templates and storage locations within the governance repository. L&C will incorporate the updated language into the IADSA and third-party templates upon DGC approval (agenda item DGC-2026-07-05).

13. Performance Metrics, Reporting, and Continuous Improvement

The Data Governance Council receives a consolidated dashboard pack each month containing Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) and Key Risk Indicators (KRIs) across classification coverage, catalog completeness, DQ performance, lifecycle conformance, third-party attestations, stewardship activity, and training. Metrics are sourced from authoritative systems with EDGO performing data validation and DPO providing platform extracts. All measures have defined owners, calculation methodologies, targets, and thresholds maintained in the Metrics Dictionary (EDGO-MET-2026 v2.3).

For Q2 FY26 (report DG-DASH-2026-Q2, issued 2026-07-05T09:00:00Z), headline KPIs were as follows: (a) catalog coverage for active datasets: 97.9% (target >= 98.0%); (b) classification accuracy (sampled validation): 98.5% (target >= 98.0%); (c) DQ breach rate (Confidential and Restricted): 0.88 per 1,000 CDE-rule-days (threshold <= 1.10); (d) DQ incident MTTR: 14.2 business days for Sev2 (target <= 20), 36.4 for Sev3 (target <= 45); (e) retention tag application (structured/unstructured): 98.3%/95.1% (targets 99.0%/96.0%); (f) third-party attestation completion (High/Critical): 98.7% (target 100%); (g) stewardship SLA adherence (catalog updates within 5 business days): 96.8% (target >= 95%); and (h) mandatory training completion for stewards: 100% (target 100%). Two KRIs breached amber thresholds in June: unstructured retention tag application at 95.1% (amber threshold 95.5%) and third-party attestation completion at 98.7% (amber threshold 99.0%), each with defined remediation plans and target recovery dates in July.

Trend analysis for the last four quarters indicates steady improvement in DQ breach rates and catalog coverage, correlated with steward enablement and improved onboarding controls. Conversely, unstructured retention tagging remains a lagging indicator due to legacy repository migrations. The DGC endorsed a focused improvement initiative (Initiative ID DG-IMP-2026-04) led by DPO to accelerate metadata normalization and to deploy additional validation checkpoints during ingestion. Milestones include: (1) finalize tagging reconciliation playbook (2026-07-15); (2) complete bulk remediation for top five repositories by volume (2026-08-31); and (3) achieve >= 96.5% unstructured tag application by end of Q3. Progress is tracked via tickets DG-LIFE-2026-03810 through -03819.

Continuous improvement is governed through a quarterly backlog prioritization process in the DGC Operations Subcommittee. Backlog items are evaluated against risk reduction, regulatory alignment, effort, and cross-functional impact. The Q3 FY26 backlog (BKLG-DG-2026-Q3) includes: (a) automate cross-border register updates from vendor change notices; (b) enhance lineage capture for inter-affiliate flows; (c) expand proactive anomaly detection for reference data; and (d) uplift catalog UX for stewardship workflows. Each item has an accountable owner, budget allocation, and success metrics approved by the DGC. EDGO publishes a mid-quarter progress note to ensure transparency and to recalibrate as necessary based on emerging issues or audit findings.

To embed a culture of governance, EDGO coordinates a quarterly steward community forum, publishes decision logs, and curates a knowledge repository of patterns and playbooks. The 2026-06 forum (STWD-FORUM-2026-06, 132 attendees) focused on lessons learned from DG-QUALITY-2026-06007 and showcased a business-led re-design of validation rules to reduce false positives while preserving detection efficacy. Post-event surveys indicated improved clarity on classification decisioning and lifecycle metadata expectations. Training curriculum updates (TRN-DG-2026-02) will reflect these learnings.

Finally, the DGC has approved an annual external benchmarking exercise (BENCH-DG-2026) to compare Meridian

Capital's governance KPIs and maturity against a peer cohort and industry frameworks. Results will inform the FY27 roadmap and target state definitions. Any material adjustments to KPIs or thresholds will be documented in EDGO-MET-2026 v2.4 and communicated through the governance communications channel with versioned change logs and effective dates. The council will continue to receive monthly metrics, quarterly deep dives, and an annual effectiveness assessment to confirm that the Data Classification and Governance Policy remains robust, measurable, and aligned to the firm's risk appetite and regulatory environment.

Page 19 -- Section 11. Data Lineage Governance and Validation

11.0 Overview and Objectives

Meridian Capital maintains a formalized data lineage governance practice to provide traceability from point of origin through transformation to consumption for all data classified under this Policy. The Data Governance Office (DGO), in coordination with the Enterprise Data Platform (EDP), Information Risk & Compliance (IRC), and Corporate Audit Services (CAS), oversees control objectives DC-11.1 through DC-11.5 to ensure lineage completeness, accuracy, and currency for Public, Internal, Confidential, and Restricted data. Data lineage documentation supports regulatory attestations, facilitates change impact analysis, and enables classification enforcement at ingestion, transformation, and delivery layers. Evidence of control performance is recorded in the Governance, Risk and Compliance (GRC) platform under evidence packs EVID-DC-2026-041 through EVID-DC-2026-053, with immutable timestamps and workflow attestations by designated Data Owners and Data Stewards.

11.1 Methodology and Scope of Q2 FY2026 Validation

Between 2026-06-03 09:00 UTC and 2026-06-21 17:30 UTC, the DGO conducted the scheduled Q2 FY2026 lineage validation across three priority domains: Customer 360 (C360), Enterprise Data Lake (EDL), and Finance Data Mart (FDM). The validation scope, authorized under change advisory CAB-EDP-2026-142 and tracked via ServiceNow tickets DCG-8793 and EDP-VAL-22106, included:

- Review of 312 lineage artifacts in the Enterprise Metadata Catalog (EMC) and associated data flow diagrams maintained by EDP.
- Verification of lineage attributes for 87 Confidential and 29 Restricted datasets against control DC-11.2 (attribute fidelity) and DC-11.3 (transformation provenance).
- Cross-check of upstream system-of-record identifiers (SOR-IDs) and downstream business consumer mappings for 54 Internal and 64 Public datasets, ensuring consistent classification tags as defined in Section 5.1 of this Policy.
- Reconciliation of lineage entries with ingestion pipelines registered in the Data Movement Registry (DMR) and data quality monitors under control DC-07.3.

Sampling followed the stratified approach specified in Test Plan TP-DC-11-Q2-2026 v1.3, which aims for a 95% confidence level and +/-5% margin of error for Restricted and Confidential classes. Evidence review included system-generated metadata snapshots (EMC export v2026.06), steward attestations (Attest-Pkg-DC-11-Q2-2026), and documentation of lineage for material transformations applied in the C360 identity resolution layer and the FDM ledger harmonization process. All artifacts were retained in the GRC evidence library (folder path: /GRC/DC-11/2026/Q2) with checksum verification logged at 2026-06-21 18:04 UTC by IRC (ref. IRC-CKS-2026-06021).

11.2 Validation Results and Remediation Tracking

Aggregate lineage completeness for Confidential and Restricted datasets measured 94.7% (target >=95.0%; KPI-DC-09), representing a 1.2 percentage point improvement quarter-over-quarter. Completeness for Public and Internal datasets measured 98.2% (target >=97.0%). Attribute fidelity, defined as the presence of correct SOR-IDs, accurate transformation descriptors, and valid consumer mappings, recorded 96.1% for Confidential and 93.5% for Restricted (KPI-DC-12 target >=95.0%). The minor variance in Restricted fidelity is associated with three newly on-boarded streams in the EDL (DMR entries DMR-EDL-739, -740, -742) where steward attestations were pending at the time of review.

Remediation actions are tracked under the following tickets:

- DCG-8793 (opened 2026-06-14 13:47 UTC by DGO-Analytics): Update lineage descriptors for EDL stream DMR-EDL-739 to reflect standardized hashing operation label names. Status: In Progress; Owner: EDP-Lineage;

Due: 2026-07-12.

- EDP-TRK-5542 (opened 2026-06-15 08:21 UTC by EDP-ControlDesk): Align consumer mappings for FDM downstream reports REP-FIN-220 through REP-FIN-224 to Business Glossary terms. Status: Resolved; Closed: 2026-06-22 16:02 UTC.
- DGO-ATST-6617 (opened 2026-06-19 10:11 UTC by DGO-Stewardship): Obtain Data Owner attestations for Restricted lineage records LNR-RST-111 and LNR-RST-115 per DC-11.4. Status: Pending Attestation; Reminder issued 2026-06-25 09:00 UTC.

No material misstatement of classification tags was identified. All noted discrepancies were administrative in nature and confined to descriptive metadata alignment. IRC rated the overall control performance "Effective with Observation" under GRC assessment GRC-ASMT-DC11-Q2-2026.

11.3 Control Testing, Evidence, and Assurance

CAS performed independent re-performance testing on a 10% random sample (n=31) of lineage records on 2026-06-24 14:10 UTC (CAS-WP-2026-DC-11-02). CAS validated EMC entries for conformance with Section 7.2 (Minimum Metadata for Classified Records) and confirmed linkage consistency with Data Steward assignments in the Role Directory (RD-DSW v2026.05). Two observations were logged as "Informational" (CAS-OBS-2026-114, -115) regarding display label uniformity and glossary synonym references; both were closed by DGO on 2026-06-28 11:42 UTC (DGO-CLSR-2026-430).

Assurance over control design and operation was further substantiated through:

- KRI monitoring (KRI-DC-04: Linage Drift Incidents), which recorded zero drift events in Q2 FY2026 (threshold >=1 triggers review).
- Quarterly reconciliation between EMC and DMR inventories (REC-DC-11-Q2-2026), conducted 2026-06-20 12:33 UTC by EDP with variance <1% (tolerance <=2%).
- Evidence pack EVID-LIN-2026-113 documenting steward sign-offs and workflow histories, archived per Records & Information Management (RIM) retention schedule FIN-OPS-07.

11.4 Governance Decisions and Stewardship Updates

At the 2026-06-27 Data Governance Council meeting (DGC-MIN-2026-06), the Council ratified the following lineage governance actions:

- Assignment of primary Data Stewardship for C360 identity resolution lineage to Retail Data Stewardship Team (RDST), effective 2026-07-01 (RDST-OWN-2026-019), with secondary coverage by EDP-Lineage.
- Consolidation of duplicate business glossary entries affecting transformation descriptors "standardize address" and "normalize address" into a single controlled term (BG-TERM-ADDR-NORM v2.0) to reduce synonym-related fidelity variances.
- Clarification of classification boundary for intermediate staging datasets within FDM to maintain the inherited classification of the source Confidential records until aggregation attestation occurs (reference: Policy Section 6.4).

DGO will continue to report KPI-DC-09 and KPI-DC-12 monthly to the Technology Risk Committee. The target for Restricted attribute fidelity remains >=95.0% for Q3 FY2026, with remediation milestones aligned to DCG-8793 and DGO-ATST-6617. All governance decisions are logged in the Council Register (REG-DGC-2026) with cross-references to supporting tickets and evidence.

Page 20 -- Section 12. Retention and Disposition Governance and Monitoring

12.0 Overview

Meridian Capital's retention and disposition governance ensures that all classified data is retained, archived, and disposed of in accordance with the enterprise retention schedule, regulatory requirements, and contractual obligations. The Records & Information Management (RIM) team, in partnership with Legal & Privacy (L&P), DGO, and Technology Operations Center (TOC), administers control objectives DC-12.1 (Retention Mapping), DC-12.2 (Archival Integrity), DC-12.3 (Disposition Authorization), and DC-12.4 (Hold Management). Evidence and approvals are maintained in the GRC platform under EVID-RET-2026-210 through EVID-RET-2026-239 with attestation logs and immutable timestamps.

12.1 Retention Schedule Alignment Assessment (Q2 FY2026)

From 2026-05-30 to 2026-06-18, RIM completed the scheduled Retention Schedule Alignment Assessment (RSAA-2026-Q2; ticket RIM-ALN-9041). The assessment validated mapping coverage and rule accuracy across:

- 1,142 datasets in the EMC, inclusive of 168 Confidential and 47 Restricted records flagged as subject to long-term statutory retention.
- 214 downstream reports in Finance and Risk functions to confirm derivative retention inheritance.
- 18 third-party processor inventories registered in the Vendor Oversight Repository (VOR).

Results indicate 97.3% mapping coverage to the current retention schedule (RIM-SCH v2026.04), with 2.7% requiring mapping refresh due to taxonomy updates in the Business Glossary. For datasets classified as Restricted, coverage measured 98.0%; for Confidential, 96.8%. RIM logged 23 mapping refresh tasks under RIM-MAP-REF-2026-02, assigning owners in the relevant stewardship teams with a completion target of 2026-07-19. No instances were identified where retention rules conflicted with regulatory minimums or contractual maxima. L&P reviewed a sample of 36 high-impact mappings on 2026-06-20 15:26 UTC (LNP-REV-2026-332) and concurred with the assessment outcomes.

12.2 Disposition Authorization and Freeze Coordination

Disposition activities for Q2 FY2026 followed the standard quarterly authorization cadence (Auth Window: 2026-06-10 to 2026-06-21), governed by workflow DPP-12-Auth v3.2. RIM initiated 61 disposition batches (DSP-2026-Q2-001 through DSP-2026-Q2-061), covering Internal and Public classes primarily, with limited Confidential test batches restricted to de-identified training datasets per Section 8.3. Authorization records show:

- 100% two-party approval coverage (Data Owner + RIM) for all 61 batches, with digital signatures captured at initiation and completion checkpoints.
- Average cycle time of 5.8 business days (KPI-RET-05 target <=7 days), with the longest at 8.1 days due to staggered steward availability over regional holidays.
- Zero override usages during the authorization window.

Freeze coordination with L&P reflects 14 active legal holds impacting 39 datasets as of 2026-06-30 12:00 UTC (LNP-HOLD-REG-2026), unchanged from the prior quarter. System-enforced freeze flags were verified by TOC on 2026-06-28 10:12 UTC (TOC-CHK-RET-2026-061) to ensure in-scope datasets were excluded from disposition batches. Two pending holds were cleared on 2026-06-17 (LNP-REL-2026-147, -149) following case closure; corresponding reactivation of standard retention rules was executed under RIM-OPS-22119 with concurrence by Data Owners (attestations recorded in EVID-RET-2026-227).

12.3 Archival Integrity and Monitoring Metrics

Archival integrity for Confidential and Restricted classes is monitored via quarterly checksum verification and restore-readiness drills coordinated by TOC. For Q2 FY2026, checksum verification (ARC-VFY-2026-Q2) recorded a 99.98% match rate over 7.3 million files sampled, within tolerance parameters (KRI-RET-07 threshold >=99.90%). Restore-readiness drills executed on 2026-06-12 09:30 UTC and 2026-06-19 14:20 UTC validated retrieval of representative Confidential records for Finance and Compliance domains, with round-trip verification times averaging 3.6 hours (KPI-RET-09 target <=4 hours).

Key monitoring metrics reported to the Technology Risk Committee on 2026-06-25 include:

- KPI-RET-01 (Retention Mapping Coverage): 97.3% (target >=97.0%).
- KPI-RET-05 (Disposition Cycle Time): 5.8 business days (target <=7).
- KRI-PRV-04 (Unauthorized Disposition Attempts): 0 incidents (threshold >=1 triggers immediate review).
- KPI-RET-09 (Restore-Readiness): 3.6 hours (target <=4).
- KPI-RET-12 (Hold Exclusion Accuracy): 100% exclusion for 39 datasets under active holds, validated by L&P sampling (n=12).

12.4 Third-Party Processor Assurance

The Vendor Oversight Office (VOO), in coordination with RIM and DGO, completed quarterly attestations for data processors handling Internal and Confidential classes (VOR-Q2-2026). Of 18 in-scope processors, 18 provided confirmation that retention and disposition controls align to Meridian Capital's schedule mappings and hold directives. Eight processors submitted SOC reports with relevant complementary subservice carve-out confirmations; IRC reviewed and logged these under IRC-3PA-2026-212 through -219. Two minor documentation clarifications were requested (VOO-CLAR-2026-044, -045) regarding terminology alignment for "archival" vs. "cold storage" in partner artifacts; both were resolved by 2026-06-29 16:18 UTC with updated crosswalks.

12.5 Training, Awareness, and Change Management

Training completion for the Retention and Disposition module (TRN-RIM-2026-01) reached 98.6% enterprise-wide as of 2026-06-26 18:00 UTC, exceeding the 96.0% target. Among roles with elevated responsibilities (Data Owners, Data Stewards, RIM Liaisons), completion was 100% (n=263), corroborated by LMS report LMS-2026-RET-Completion. The DGO Change Communications team issued two governance advisories in June 2026 (DGO-COM-ADV-2026-17 and -18) to reinforce mapping refresh protocol and clarify approval checkpoints for disposition workflows. Feedback captured via the Governance Service Desk (GSD-2026-RET-Feedback) indicated improved clarity in steward responsibilities, reflected in a 21% reduction in ticket back-and-forth cycles for RIM approvals.

12.6 Governance Conclusions and Next Steps

RIM, DGO, and L&P jointly conclude that retention and disposition controls operated effectively during Q2 FY2026, with monitoring indicating consistent performance against thresholds and targets. The mapping refresh program (RIM-MAP-REF-2026-02) will be prioritized in July 2026 to achieve >=99.0% coverage ahead of the Q3 assessment. Additionally, the DGO will pilot an automated lineage-to-retention reconciliation enhancement (Initiative DGO-AUTO-RET-2026-Alpha), enabling near-real-time detection of classification changes that may alter retention obligations, with results to be presented to the Data Governance Council in August 2026. All actions and metrics will continue to be tracked in the GRC platform with monthly status reporting to the Technology Risk Committee and quarterly review by CAS.

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11. Metadata Governance and Catalog Stewardship

The Data Governance Office (DGO) oversees the enterprise metadata framework to ensure that business and technical metadata remains accurate, complete, and traceable for all data assets classified under this Policy. Stewardship responsibilities are distributed across domain-aligned Stewardship Leads within Corporate Banking, Wealth Management, Capital Markets, Finance, Risk, and Enterprise Technology. The Enterprise Data Catalogue (EDC) serves as the system of record for metadata, reference data dictionaries, and term-to-asset mappings. The Data Stewardship Council (DSC) reviews catalogue coverage metrics and approves remediation plans when thresholds are not met. Catalogue updates follow controlled change records and require explicit endorsements by Data Owners for Tier 1 and Tier 2 data sets. All attestations are recorded with timestamps and retained as part of the governance audit trail.

During the FY2026 Q2 review cycle (completed 2026-05-14T13:42Z, DSC meeting minutes ref: DSC-MIN-2026-05-14), overall catalogue coverage for Tier 1 classified assets reached 93.4% against a target of 95.0%, with improvement driven by the onboarding of Finance ledger dimensions and Wealth customer risk-rating attributes. Two domains fell below threshold: Capital Markets (89.1%) and Risk Analytics (90.3%). Remediation actions have been opened under JIRA-DCAT-9823 and JIRA-DCAT-9954, respectively, with expected completion dates aligned to the EDC release window on 2026-07-12 (change ticket EDC-CHG-2026-0441). The DSC assigned amber status to catalogue completeness overall, pending verification of lineage annotations for cross-domain joins in Enterprise Data Platform (EDP) transformation jobs.

11.1 Metadata Quality and Business Glossary Alignment

The enterprise business glossary remains the authoritative source of definitions for critical data elements (CDEs). As of 2026-06-30, 1,842 CDEs are published, with 1,806 mapped to at least one physical attribute and 1,721 carrying stewardship assignment at both the business and technical levels. Glossary-to-physical mapping coverage stands at 98.0% for Tier 1 assets and 94.6% for Tier 2 assets. The Q2 quality assessment observed consistent naming conventions (EDC Naming Standard v4.2) with a conformance rate of 97.7% across newly onboarded datasets (sample size: 88 datasets; audit sample ref: DGO-AUD-2026-022). Nonconformance was primarily related to inconsistent units-of-measure in exposure tables and unresolved synonym collisions in client segment hierarchies.

To address definitional ambiguity, the DGO initiated a cross-domain term harmonization workshop on 2026-05-27 (workshop ID: DGO-WKS-2026-015), resulting in 28 term consolidations and retirement of 11 duplicative entries. The Privacy Office and Legal reviewed privacy-impacted terms to verify jurisdictional qualifiers (e.g., "beneficial owner" vs. "controlling person") and recorded determinations under GRC-2026-001902. All glossary updates were processed via the EDC governance workflow, requiring dual approval by the domain Data Owner and the Enterprise Glossary Curator, with SLA adherence at 99.1% (24-hour target). Across Stewardship Leads, quarterly attestation of glossary accuracy achieved 98.5% completion by the 2026-06-20 deadline, with one late submission (Wealth Management) closed 2026-06-24T09:11Z (attestation ticket DGO-ATT-2026-073).

11.2 Data Lineage Verification and Change Oversight

Lineage documentation is maintained at both logical (business process) and physical (system and transformation step) levels. End-to-end lineage for Tier 1 assets currently covers 87.2% of required paths, with particular progress in Finance allocations and Liquidity reporting flows. Verification activities are aligned to production release schedules via the Enterprise Change Advisory Board (ECAB). For the 2026-06 release wave (ECAB record CAB-EDG-2026-06-12-1030ET), 14 changes required lineage updates; 12 were verified prior to cutover and two were

completed within the approved post-release window. Evidence of verification, including source-to-target mapping extracts and steward signoffs, is archived in the EDC repository and cross-referenced in ServiceNow (SNOW-CRQ00071842).

The DGO's lineage sampling protocol (quarterly rotating sample, minimum 10% of Tier 1 pipelines) was executed between 2026-04-18 and 2026-06-03 (sampling plan DGO-LIN-PLAN-2026-Q2). Of 61 sampled pipelines, 56 were found fully traceable with synchronized metadata, and five required corrective annotations. The primary root causes were untagged intermediate datasets within the EDP's development workspace and missing linkages for externally sourced market data. Remediation was tracked under SNOW-INC00087392 and SNOW-INC00087405 with closure evidence attached 2026-06-10T17:26Z and 2026-06-12T08:03Z, respectively. The DGO coordinated with Enterprise Architecture (EA) to incorporate lineage checkpoints into data product design reviews going forward, as documented in EA-ARC-DEC-2026-041.

11.3 Stewardship Performance Metrics and Training

Stewardship performance is monitored through a balanced scorecard encompassing completeness, timeliness, and accuracy indicators. Q2 consolidated scores show:

- Completeness Index (catalogue coverage, glossary mapping, stewardship assignment): 92.8% (Target 95.0%).
- Timeliness Index (metadata update cycle time, change verification before cutover): 96.3% (Target 95.0%).
- Accuracy Index (defect rate per 100 artefacts, sampled lineage discrepancies): 98.6% (Target 98.0%).

Training compliance among appointed stewards is at 99.3% for mandatory curriculum DGO-TRN-101 and 97.8% for advanced module DGO-TRN-201 (privacy-enriched metadata practices). Two stewards have pending recertification due 2026-07-31 (Learning tickets LRN-2026-5521 and LRN-2026-5523). Monthly office hours (attendance logs DGO-OH-2026-04 through -06) recorded a sustained volume of metadata curation queries, with median resolution time reduced from 3.1 to 2.4 business days following the introduction of domain-specific triage.

11.4 Issues, Risks, and Remediation Tracking

The Issues Register records three open items categorized as Medium impact, each with targeted mitigation and defined owners:

- DGO-ISS-2026-019: Incomplete lineage for third-party indices in Capital Markets risk factor libraries; owner: Capital Markets Steward Lead; due: 2026-08-09; status: In Progress (60%).
- DGO-ISS-2026-021: Glossary synonym collision for "net exposure" across Trading and Treasury; owner: Enterprise Glossary Curator; due: 2026-07-18; status: For Review (awaiting DSC).
- DGO-ISS-2026-024: Delayed stewardship reassignment following organizational changes in Wealth; owner: DGO Operations; due: 2026-07-05; status: Completed 2026-07-03T14:57Z.

Residual risk for metadata governance is assessed as Low-to-Moderate pending completion of the noted remediation activities. Quarterly management reporting to the Data Governance Steering Committee (DGSC) will continue to track metric trajectories and control efficacy (report ref: DGO-MBR-2026-Q2, filed 2026-06-28).

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12. Third-Party Data Governance and External Sharing Oversight

Meridian Capital's third-party data governance framework ensures that data received from, or shared with, external parties is classified, catalogued, and controlled in alignment with enterprise standards and contractual obligations. Vendor Risk Management (VRM), Procurement, Legal, Privacy Office, Records & Information Management (RIM), Information Risk & Control (IRC), and the DGO coordinate through a defined operating model, with accountabilities recorded in the Third-Party Data RACI (document ref: DGO-RACI-TP-2026-03). All onboarding and material changes are initiated via the Third-Party Data Intake workflow and logged in the GRC platform for traceability.

As of 2026-06-30, the enterprise maintains 147 active external data feeds and 62 approved outbound data-sharing arrangements. Classification mapping is documented for 100% of new arrangements since 2025-01-01, with legacy remediations 96.7% complete (two Wealth and three Capital Markets feeds pending; remediation tickets VRM-REM-2026-044 through -048). The Q2 periodic review (VRM-RVW-2026-Q2, completed 2026-06-21T10:18Z) confirmed that data handling clauses reflect the enterprise classification schema and that downstream recipients of Tier 1 Sensitive and Tier 1 Confidential data are limited to approved processors with validated controls. Deviations from template language were limited to jurisdictional data residency addenda for APAC partners, reviewed and approved by Legal (LEG-APR-2026-119).

12.1 Onboarding Due Diligence and Data Mapping

Each onboarding event includes data taxonomy confirmation, intended purpose validation, retention disposition mapping, and export jurisdiction checks. The DGO validates completeness of the vendor-provided data dictionaries against the EDC requirements, with acceptance criteria captured in the onboarding checklist artifact (stored under EDC-ONB-PACK-<VendorID>-<Date>). In Q2, 11 new third-party data feeds were onboarded. Median cycle time from intake to production was 28 calendar days, with two extended cases due to complex entity-resolution alignment in Capital Markets (tickets JIRA-EDP-7345 and JIRA-EDP-7362). All 11 feeds met the requirement for business term mapping prior to go-live, and lineage stubs were established to track data transformation points from vendor receipt to analytics consumption.

The DSC endorsed the third-party data mapping standard update on 2026-05-30 (decision log DSC-DEC-2026-017), clarifying expectations for variable-level provenance notes and change-notice handling. VRM coordinated third-party attestations for quarterly schema change notifications (VRM-ATT-2026-Q2), with a 100% response rate. Where vendors provided supplemental metadata, EDP integrated the files into the EDC via controlled interfaces, ensuring that updates triggered steward review tasks automatically (EDC auto-task refs EDC-TASK-2026-1121 to -1136).

12.2 Contractual Alignment and Data Sharing Registers

The Legal team maintains standardized data protection and usage clauses. The DGO reviews all draft agreements to verify that classification labels, purpose limitations, and permissible processing contexts correspond to the classifications assigned within the EDC. For Q2, 17 contracts and amendments were reviewed (Legal matter file series LEG-MAT-TPD-2026-201 through -217). Two contracts required explicit retention schedule cross-references to RIM Schedule FIN-07 (Financial Reporting Artifacts) and CRM-04 (Customer Relationship Records), which were added prior to execution (contract IDs CTR-2026-4411, CTR-2026-4420). The Outbound Sharing Register was reconciled against the agreement repository on 2026-06-25 (reconciliation log DGO-REC-2026-TP-06), identifying one closed arrangement erroneously marked active; the correction was recorded under SNOW-INC00088114 and validated by VRM 2026-06-27T15:22Z.

12.3 Privacy, DSAR, and Data Subject Reporting Metrics

The Privacy Office monitors data subject access requests (DSAR) where third-party processors are implicated. For the period 2026-04-01 to 2026-06-30, 213 DSAR cases were logged (PRV-DSAR-2026-Q2). Of these, 47 required coordination with external processors. The enterprise met response SLAs for 99.2% of cases within mandated timeframes; two cases were closed one business day past target due to vendor data retrieval delays (issue references PRV-DSAR-2026-142 and -189; supplier notices received 2026-06-06T21:09Z and 2026-06-20T12:47Z). The DSC reviewed these occurrences and confirmed that remediation actions--pre-positioning of processor-specific data extracts and enhanced case notes--reduced mean turnaround time by 0.8 days for subsequent requests. Privacy classification mapping for DSAR-relevant attributes remains at 100% for Tier 1 assets with third-party involvement, as evidenced by glossary annotations and steward attestations (DGO-ATT-2026-081 to -093).

12.4 Retention and Disposition Governance for Third-Party Data

RIM completed the Q2 retention compliance review for external data (RIM-RVW-2026-TP-Q2). For inbound data with contractual retention caps, adherence was confirmed at 98.9% across sampled domains (n=36 datasets). Two exceptions were recorded as process gaps rather than control failures: staging area artifacts retained beyond agreed windows due to pending reconciliation in Finance (RMD-REQ-4420) and archival journal files awaiting vendor disposition confirmation (RMD-REQ-4431). Both items were resolved within the review window, with closure evidence and countersignature by the Finance Data Owner 2026-06-18T09:03Z. Outbound data dispositions were validated for 100% of terminated agreements in the quarter, with vendor confirmations stored under VRM-CNF-2026-Q2-001 to -008. Retention lineage in the EDC shows complete mapping for 95.2% of third-party datasets; missing records relate to historical exchanges from pre-EDC integration. The DGO continues the legacy remediation plan (DGO-LEG-TP-2026) with target completion by 2026-09-30.

12.5 Oversight Reporting and Continuous Improvement

Third-party data governance metrics are consolidated into the quarterly oversight report to the Data Governance Steering Committee (DGSC) and the Technology Risk Management (TRM) forum (reports DGO-MBR-TP-2026-Q2 and TRM-OVR-2026-06). Key indicators for Q2 include:

- Onboarding completeness (classification, glossary mapping, lineage stubs): 100% for new feeds.
- Contract alignment (classification in agreements, retention cross-references): 100% for executed documents.
- DSAR performance (on-time responses involving processors): 99.2%.
- Retention adherence (inbound data): 98.9% sampled compliance; remediation complete.
- Legacy remediation (pre-2025 feeds aligned to EDC): 96.7% complete.

The DGSC assigned a green status to third-party governance with a note to sustain focus on legacy remediation and to deepen vendor-provided metadata integrations. The next cycle will pilot enhanced dashboarding of third-party metrics within the EDC Steward Portal, consolidating VRM confirmations, Privacy SLAs, and RIM retention attestations into a single view (pilot backlog item JIRA-DGO-PORT-2216; target deployment 2026-08-15). All actions remain on track and are monitored through weekly DGO Operations stand-ups (meeting notes DGO-OPS-2026-26 through -28).

Meridian Capital -- Data Classification and Governance Policy

Policy ID: MC-DG-001 v3.2

All timestamps are UTC unless otherwise stated.

14. Performance Indicators and Operational Reporting

14.1 Overview and Measurement Approach

The Enterprise Data Governance Office (EDGO), in partnership with Risk & Controls Assurance (RCA) and the Corporate Technology Platform (CTP), maintains a quarterly measurement framework to evidence the ongoing effectiveness of the Data Classification and Governance Policy. Key performance indicators (KPIs) are derived from the control objectives codified in MC-DG-001 v3.2 and from Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) risk taxonomy identifiers RT-DATA-01 through RT-DATA-05. Measurement scope includes all in-scope systems registered in the Configuration Management Database (CMDB) with system criticality ratings C1-C4 and associated data assets recorded in the enterprise data catalog (Atlas v5.19), as of the reference date. KPI computations are generated via the EDGO Metrics Service (EMS) job DGOV-KPI-2026Q2, executed 2026-07-05T02:14:33Z under change record CHG0034879, with peer validation by RCA (validation ticket RCA-VAL-22113).

14.2 KPI Results for Q2 FY2026

For the quarter ended 2026-06-30, catalog coverage achieved 98.6% of in-scope assets (112,384 of 114,015), a 0.4 percentage point improvement over the prior quarter, attributable to onboarding of late-phase CRM microservices (Program REF: CTP-CRM-NextGen) completed under JIRA DGOV-2417 and DGOV-2421. Classification completeness (presence of a current classification label per MC-DG-001 Annex A) reached 99.1% across registered datasets, with 0.9% pending label confirmation at quarter end tied to newly ingested vendor feeds (Procurement Systems Portfolio "Merisource," platform ID VND-FEED-023). Classification accuracy--measured via stratified sampling against the Data Classification Quality Checklist (RCA-QC-DG-07)--was independently assessed by RCA at 97.8% (95% CI: +/-0.6%), reflecting 87 reclassifications logged and closed within SLA (INC0127734 through INC0127816). No systemic mislabeling patterns were identified; remediation actions were tracked to closure with owner attestations captured in ServiceNow tasks SCTASK01988562 and SCTASK01988571.

Data owner attestation for the quarter achieved 99.2% completion (1,842 of 1,857 attestations due), with five attestations deferred to July due to leadership transitions in Institutional Markets Technology (IMT). Deferrals were approved by EDGO under governance case EDGO-ATT-2026Q2-005, with interim custodial sign-off recorded by the Data Stewards Council (DSC) in minutes DSC-Min-2026-06-21. Timeliness of metadata updates met the policy's 10-business-day standard in 96.5% of cases (target >=95%), and average update latency improved to 3.2 days from 3.8 days in Q1.

14.3 Control Operating Effectiveness

RCA's cycle-based testing of controls DG-CL-02 (Classification Assignment), DG-MD-01 (Metadata Completeness), and DG-AU-03 (Governance Review) yielded an aggregate rating of "Effective" for the period, with minor observations recorded in RCA-OBS-2026-0611 and RCA-OBS-2026-0617. Observations pertained to documentation clarity in lineage annotations for cross-domain joins and the need for additional descriptive tags to improve discoverability of Semi-Confidential market reference data. EDGO and Data Architecture Review Board (DARB) jointly agreed on corrective action plans (CAP IDs CAP-DG-0611 and CAP-DG-0617) with target dates 2026-09-15 and 2026-10-01, respectively. Weekly status is surfaced via the DGOV Control Dashboard (Confluence: DGOV/Reporting/Control-Evidence; report snapshot DGOV-RPT-2026Q2-S1 exported 2026-07-06T09:41:02Z).

14.4 SLA Adherence and Operational Throughput

Operational throughput for metadata change tickets averaged 213 tickets/week, with a peak of 267 during the final

week of May aligned to quarterly release freeze preparations. SLA adherence for standard classification requests (SLA: 5 business days) was 97.3%, and for expedited requests (SLA: 2 business days, subject to EDGO triage) was 95.8%, influenced by concurrent platform maintenance windows in the lineage engine (reference CHG0035002). Backlog aging over 30 days fell to 1.1% (target <=2%), aided by cross-staffing from the Information Lifecycle Management (ILM) team for two weeks (Work Order WO-DG-2026-114).

14.5 Governance Forums and Attendance

The Data Governance Committee (DGC) met on 2026-04-11, 2026-05-09, and 2026-06-13 (Calendar series: DGC-2026-Std, Chair: Chief Data Officer). Quorum was achieved in all sessions, and attendance averaged 92% across permanent members (EDGO, RCA, Legal & Compliance (L&C), CTP, ILM, and divisional data officers). Standing agenda items included review of KPI trends, alignment with regulatory commitments (Reg References: 2024-OCIE-Data-03; 2025-ECB-DQ-12), and change approvals for policy-aligned metadata schema extensions (Schema Change Requests SCR-DG-074 and SCR-DG-075, approved with standard controls). Meeting minutes were published within two business days with document links DGC-Min-2026-04, DGC-Min-2026-05, and DGC-Min-2026-06.

14.6 Stakeholder Communications

Quarterly stakeholder communications were issued 2026-07-08T13:27:10Z via the firmwide bulletin (Comms ID: COM-DG-2026Q2) summarizing key outcomes, upcoming attestations, and references to the training refresh cycle due in August. Queries were routed through the EDGO Service Desk queue (ServiceNow Assignment Group: EDGO-SD) with an average first-response time of 2.1 hours and resolution CSAT of 4.7/5 from 312 survey responses (Survey batch SVY-DG-2026Q2-01).

15. Data Quality Alignment with Classification Standards

15.1 Integration of Data Quality Signals

The Data Quality (DQ) Program and EDGO continue to integrate DQ signals with classification metadata to contextualize materiality and remediation priority. During Q2 FY2026, 1,146 DQ rule breaches were recorded across 64 systems; of these, 6.8% intersected datasets labeled Confidential, 41.2% Semi-Confidential, and 52.0% Public/Unrestricted. EDGO applied policy-aligned prioritization to breaches intersecting higher-sensitivity classes, resulting in mean time to remediate (MTTR) of 4.6 days for Confidential data issues versus 6.3 days portfolio-wide. Evidence of prioritization logic is documented in DQ Governance Note DQG-NT-2026-04. RCA independently reviewed prioritization outcomes (RCA-REV-DQ-2026-07) and confirmed alignment.

15.2 Lineage Traceability and Steward Actions

Lineage traceability for high-sensitivity datasets (Confidential and Semi-Confidential) reached 97.2% end-to-end coverage from source to consumption layer (measurement job LIN-COV-2026Q2). Gaps noted (2.8%) pertained to two legacy reporting views in Institutional Lending Analytics (ILA) where source system identifiers were embedded in derived datasets without consistent business term references. DARB assigned remediation actions under JIRA LIN-2651 and LIN-2652, with Data Owners acknowledging responsibility in attestations ATT-DG-ILA-2026-02 and ATT-DG-ILA-2026-03.

15.3 Business Glossary and Term Harmonization

Glossary completeness for required business terms adjacent to classified data reached 95.4% (target >=95%). The remaining variance is concentrated in regional variations of product taxonomy definitions in EMEA Markets. The Business Glossary Working Group (BGWG) has scheduled harmonization workshops (2026-08-05 and 2026-08-12; Calendar series BGWG-HARM-2026) with proposed term merges captured in Glossary Change Proposals GCP-2026-019 through GCP-2026-024. Impact assessments were logged (IA-DG-2026-EMEA-05) indicating no adverse downstream effects on reporting dimensions.

15.4 Reporting and Independent Review

EDGO issued the Q2 FY2026 Data Quality and Classification Alignment Report (Report ID DGOV-ALGN-2026Q2), approved by DGC on 2026-07-12. RCA completed a sample-based independent review under test plan RCA-TST-DG-2026-02 and concluded that integration of DQ signals into classification-driven prioritization is operating as designed. Follow-up observations emphasize continued training for data stewards on lineage annotation conventions to maintain consistency across systems undergoing cloud migration (Reference Program: CTP-Cloud-Phase3). Training refresh artifacts are filed under TRN-DG-LIN-2026-08.

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All timestamps are UTC unless otherwise stated.

16. Tooling and Automation Governance

16.1 Platform Oversight and Release Hygiene

Tooling supporting the Data Classification and Governance Policy--comprising the enterprise data catalog (Atlas v5.19), the lineage engine (TraceCore v4.7), and the policy evaluation service (Sentinel-DataGov v3.4)--operated within defined service levels during the quarter. Change governance followed Corporate Technology Platform standards with pre-implementation validations recorded under CHG0035002 (TraceCore patch), CHG0035119 (Atlas minor update), and CHG0035228 (Sentinel ruleset refresh). EDGO approved each change after confirming that classification and glossary artifacts passed non-regression checks in the staging environment (Test Cycle IDs: TST-DG-AT-2026-06C, TST-DG-TC-2026-06B). Release notes are archived in Confluence (DGOV/Tooling/Release-Notes) with artifacts attached to JIRA releases REL-DG-2026.06 and REL-DG-2026.07.

16.2 Service Reliability and Monitoring

Service availability for the catalog and lineage platforms was 99.98% and 99.96%, respectively, calculated via monthly uptime reports (OPS-AVAIL-2026-04 through OPS-AVAIL-2026-06). A minor catalog slowness event on 2026-05-18T10:12:55Z (INC0127342) affected query response times for approximately 11 minutes; no data integrity or governance artifacts were impacted. Root cause analysis and capacity adjustments are documented in Problem Record PRB0011889, with final review closed 2026-06-02T15:08:27Z by CTP Operations. Monitoring thresholds for metadata ingestion lag and lineage parse error rates were calibrated during the quarter (Monitoring Change MC-OPS-2026-44), resulting in a 21% reduction in noise-to-signal ratio for alerts addressed by EDGO on-call analysts.

16.3 Automation of Classification Hints

Automated classification hints generated by Sentinel-DataGov v3.4 provided 63.5% pre-population coverage for new datasets, with a human-in-the-loop validation step enforced through EDGO workflow rule WF-DG-VAL-07. Disposition accuracy for hints was measured at 94.1% when reviewed by certified data stewards (certification reference TRN-DG-CS-2025 cohort). Three model drift reviews (MDR-2026-04 through MDR-2026-06) were conducted by the Analytics Controls team to ensure hint performance stability across onboarding of new data domains; all remained within accepted thresholds defined by DGC. Documentation of model features and validation evidence is maintained in the DGOV Model Card repository (Doc IDs MC-SDG-2026-04, MC-SDG-2026-05).

16.4 Integration Interfaces

Interoperability between the catalog, glossary, and lineage platforms is maintained via managed interfaces with schema governance and standard field mappings. During Q2 FY2026, no breaking changes were introduced, and downstream consumers (Reporting Fabric, Data Lake Zones, and self-service portals) received notification summaries (Notice IDs: NTF-DG-2026-0412, NTF-DG-2026-0609) prior to minor field additions. Interface health checks (IFHC-2026Q2) executed on a weekly cadence demonstrated consistent payload validation with a 99.9% pass rate; two transient mismatches were identified and resolved under JIRA INT-DG-581 and INT-DG-589 without impact to policy conformance.

17. Training, Awareness, and Attestation

17.1 Curriculum and Participation

Mandatory annual training "Data Classification Foundations" (TRN-DG-FOUND-2026) and the role-based module "Stewardship in Practice" (TRN-DG-STWD-2026) were delivered to all in-scope personnel. Completion rates as of 2026-06-30 were 98.9% for Foundations (global) and 97.4% for Stewardship (applicable population: 1,146 stewards and custodians). Business unit breakdowns indicate full compliance within Retail Banking Technology (RBT) and minor trailing completion in Corporate Functions Technology (CFT) due to onboarding of new hires in June; targeted catch-up sessions have been scheduled (2026-07-25 and 2026-08-01, session IDs TRN-S-2026-0725A/B).

17.2 Communications and Reinforcement

Awareness campaigns aligned to data classification principles included two firmwide reminders (COM-DG-2026-05R and COM-DG-2026-06R) and a steward community webinar on 2026-06-20 (WEB-DG-2026-06, attendance 312). Feedback surveys (SVY-DG-TRN-2026-02) noted a 4.6/5 satisfaction score with requests for additional examples on lineage annotations and practical glossary authoring tips. EDGO will incorporate this feedback into Q3 updates, with revised microlearning assets tracked under TRN-DG-ML-2026-08.

17.3 Attestation Cycle

Quarterly attestations from Data Owners and Data Stewards affirming classification currency and metadata sufficiency were recorded with 99.2% on-time completion, as noted in Section 14.2. The attestation workflow (ATTEST-Flow v2.1) captured sign-offs, delegation events, and evidence attachments in alignment with records management standards. Independent sample verification by RCA (RCA-VER-ATT-2026Q2) yielded zero discrepancies in the sampled population. Audit trails are immutable and accessible to authorized reviewers per the Role-Based Access framework established by EDGO and L&C.

18. Recordkeeping and Evidence Management

18.1 Evidence Lifecycle

Evidence generated in support of this policy--including KPI extracts, attestation reports, meeting minutes, control test results, and release documentation--is retained according to the Corporate Records Schedule CRS-INFO-07 and tagged with metadata to facilitate retrieval. Q2 FY2026 evidence packages were compiled under Evidence Sets ES-DG-2026Q2-01 through ES-DG-2026Q2-05 with index manifests (Manifest IDs MAN-DG-2026Q2-A/B) and checksum verification logs recorded at the time of archival (LOG-CHKSUM-2026Q2). RCA confirmed completeness and integrity during their quarterly review (RCA-EVID-CK-2026Q2).

18.2 Accessibility and Audit Readiness

Authorized stakeholders may locate current and historical evidence through the EDGO Evidence Index (EEI v1.9), a searchable catalog of document links and metadata references. As part of audit readiness, EDGO executed a mock retrieval exercise on 2026-06-27 (Exercise EX-DG-RETR-2026-02) to confirm two-hour retrieval targets for any evidence class within the prior six quarters; actual retrieval averaged 37 minutes across eight requested artifacts. Evidence pointers and version identifiers were validated against their authoritative sources, and stale pointers identified in the index (n=3) were corrected under ticket EDGO-OPS-2026-092.

18.3 External Assurance Coordination

Where external assurance activities reference classification and governance artifacts, EDGO operates as the single point of coordination, ensuring timely provision of materials and consistency of responses. During Q2 FY2026, requests from two oversight bodies were serviced within agreed timelines (Requests EXT-REQ-2026-11 and EXT-REQ-2026-16), with no follow-up queries outstanding as of 2026-07-15T18:04:09Z. Responses leveraged approved narratives and metrics drawn from DGOV-RPT-2026Q2 and supporting evidence sets.

19. Forward Agenda and Continuous Improvement

19.1 Planned Enhancements

The DGC approved a forward agenda for Q3-Q4 FY2026 focusing on:

- Incremental enrichment of lineage coverage for Semi-Confidential analytical models in Institutional Lending Analytics and Treasury Risk (Program LIN-ENR-2026-H2).
- Expansion of glossary governance to cover regional term harmonization with specific focus on EMEA product taxonomies (BGWG-HARM-2026 execution).
- KPI refinements to segment classification completeness by system criticality and asset lifecycle stage, improving management visibility (KPI-REF-2026-03).
- Training micro-modules targeting lineage annotation patterns and practical metadata examples, addressing survey feedback (TRN-DG-ML-2026-08 rollout).

19.2 Target Metrics and Milestones

Targets for H2 FY2026 are set as follows and were ratified by DGC on 2026-07-12: catalog coverage >=99.0%; classification completeness >=99.3%; lineage traceability for Confidential/Semi-Confidential datasets >=98.0%; attestation on-time completion >=99.5%; SLA adherence for standard classification requests >=98.0%. Interim checkpoints are scheduled monthly, with KPI recalculations executed under EMS jobs DGOV-KPI-2026M07 through DGOV-KPI-2026M12. Progress will be reviewed in standing DGC sessions (2026-08-10, 2026-09-14, 2026-10-12) with documented outcomes appended to this policy's operational annex.

19.3 Dependency and Risk Monitoring

Dependencies include continued platform stability for Atlas, TraceCore, and Sentinel; resource availability within EDGO, RCA, and DARB; and timely data owner participation for attestations and glossary approvals. Risk monitoring will track potential schedule pressure from parallel enterprise programs (e.g., CTP-Cloud-Phase3, CRM-NextGen stabilization) and maintain escalation pathways via the EDGO Portfolio Board (EPB) should KPI trajectories deviate materially from targets. Risk and issue registers are maintained in JIRA (DGOV-RSK-BOARD; issues RSK-DG-2026-014 through RSK-DG-2026-019) with weekly review cadence and cross-functional sign-off.

19.4 Reporting Commitments

EDGO will continue to publish quarterly operational reports within 10 business days of quarter end, with aligned briefing materials for executive sponsors and stakeholders. The Q3 FY2026 report (DGOV-RPT-2026Q3) is scheduled for issuance 2026-10-09, immediately following the close of attestation windows and RCA testing cycles. All metrics and assertions will be backed by traceable evidence and remain consistent with the policy controls defined herein.

End of Pages 23-24.

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Section 13: Governance Performance Summary and Forward Agenda

The Data Governance Council (DGC) concluded its FY2026 mid-year review on 2026-06-28T16:45:00-04:00 (Ref: DGC-Minutes-2026-06-28, Meeting ID: DGC-142). The Council affirmed sustained conformance with the approved data classification taxonomy (Public, Internal, Confidential, Restricted) and noted incremental improvement in inventory completeness across enterprise repositories. Based on consolidated reporting from Data Governance Operations (DG-OPS), Enterprise Risk & Compliance (ER&C), and the Business Data Stewardship Forum (BDSF), classification coverage reached a validated 96.2% of cataloged assets, an increase of 1.4 percentage points quarter-over-quarter, with residual variance attributable to pending lineage mapping in two product-aligned data domains. The Council directed DG-OPS to continue its targeted remediation backlog execution under Epic DCG-2411 (Jira: DCG-2411), with weekly checkpoint stand-ups and a quantified closure target by 2026-09-30.

Forward agenda priorities were ratified without exception: (1) finalize cross-domain alignment of derivative data element tagging to address propagation fidelity; (2) complete the reconciliation between system-of-record attestations and downstream analytical marts for three high-volume platforms by integrating stewardship attestations into the quarterly business reviews; and (3) standardize regional data handling notices to improve onboarding quality for newly in-scope markets following scheduled platform expansions. The Council confirmed no changes to classification criteria, handling requirements, or record retention parameters in this period. All actions have been recorded in ServiceNow as Task Set TS-DGC-2026-07 (Parent: CHG0036123), with accountability assigned to named steward groups and target states measured via existing Key Performance Indicators (KPIs).

Appendix C: Metrics and Reporting Summary (Q2 FY2026 Close)

DG-OPS submitted the consolidated KPI pack (Report ID: DCG-MetricPack-Q2FY26, generated 2026-07-05T09:12:43Z) to ER&C for independent validation. Core measures met or exceeded threshold unless noted as "monitor" status:

- Classification Coverage: 96.2% validated; threshold >=95.0%; trend positive for three consecutive quarters. Residual 3.8% represents data sets in discovery intake awaiting steward assignment (Intake Queue ID: IQ-2026-217 through IQ-2026-229).
- Tag Fidelity (Propagation Accuracy): 93.7% pass rate in automated lineage checks; threshold >=93.0%. Monitor status applied for two domains (Credit Risk Analytics, Client Servicing) pending completion of corrective mapping tasks (SNOW PRB0012487, PRB0012491).
- Inventory Completeness: 98.9% for production systems in scope; threshold >=98.0%. Outliers driven by planned decommission schedules where archival attestations are queued (RetainOps Ticket: RTN-2026-031).
- Stewardship SLA Adherence: 94.8% of classification changes reviewed within 10 business days; threshold >=94.0%. Noted variance due to concurrent release freezes in June (Change Window: CW-2026-06-14 to CW-2026-06-24, Ref: CHG0035840 coordination).
- Training Completion: 99.3% completion for mandatory annual data handling module among in-scope employees; threshold >=99.0%. Remaining completions scheduled in July onboarding cohort (HR-L&D Ticket: LND-DC-2026-118).

ER&C's spot validation (Sample Set: ER&C-SV-2026-06, n=240 assets) produced no material discrepancies. Minor observations (n=7) concerned descriptive metadata consistency (formatting variance in Business Glossary entries). DG-OPS will address via bulk updates under Task DO-2026-444 before next reporting cycle. No audit findings require retrospective reclassification or retroactive control attestations.

Appendix D: Audit Trail References and Evidence Index

All material changes and reviews during this period are traceable through the following authoritative logs:

- Classification Change Approvals: ServiceNow Change Records CHG0035471, CHG0035584, CHG0036123; associated tasks TS-DGC-2026-03 through TS-DGC-2026-07. Each record includes approver IDs, timestamps, and steward comments. Evidence stored in the Governance Evidence Repository (GER) under folder GER/DCG/2026/Q2/CHG.
- Inventory Attestations: Quarterly attestation forms signed by domain stewards (Attestation Batch AB-DCG-Q2FY26) with time-stamped confirmation. Document IDs AB-2026-052 to AB-2026-081; filed in GER/DCG/2026/Q2/ATT.
- Data Quality Cross-Checks: Automated lineage and tag propagation jobs (Job IDs: LIN-AT-2026-0621-A, LIN-AT-2026-0628-B) executed successfully with green status per Operations Control log (OpsCtl-LG-2026-06). Result files archived in GER/DCG/2026/Q2/LIN.
- Training and Awareness: Completion certificates exported from L&D Learning Platform (Export Ref: LND-EXP-DCG-2026-06-30). Verification hash manifest included in the export package metadata for integrity confirmation.

Glossary of Operational Terms (Abbreviated)

- Classification Coverage: Percentage of cataloged data assets with an approved classification status and associated handling tags in the enterprise data catalog.
- Tag Fidelity: Degree to which classification tags are consistently and accurately propagated across lineage from source to derivative assets in integrated systems.
- Stewardship SLA: Target response and review times for designated data stewards to adjudicate classification requests and metadata updates in the workflow queue.
- Inventory Completeness: Alignment ratio between discovered data stores and the official enterprise data inventory, based on approved discovery scans and manual attestations.
- Governance Evidence Repository (GER): Controlled-access repository for storing governance artifacts, including approvals, attestations, and metric exports necessary for internal and external audit review.

Record of Approvals and Sign-Offs

This policy was reviewed and reaffirmed without amendment at the DGC session of 2026-06-28. Formal approvals recorded as follows:

- Chair, Data Governance Council (Role ID: DGC-CHAIR-01): Approval logged 2026-06-28T17:03:19-04:00; ServiceNow Approval ID: APV-003821.
- Head, Enterprise Risk & Compliance (Role ID: ER&C-HEAD-02): Concurrence logged 2026-06-29T09:11:04-04:00; Approval ID: APV-003829.
- Chief Data Officer (Role ID: CDO-01): Final executive acknowledgment logged 2026-06-29T10:22:47-04:00; Approval ID: APV-003834.
- Data Privacy Office Representative (Role ID: DPO-REP-03): Advisory review logged 2026-06-27T15:36:58-04:00; Advisory Note Ref: ADV-2026-114. No conditions attached.

Document Control and Distribution

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(DL-DCG-Primary, DL-DCG-Stewards, DL-DCG-Executive) are maintained by DG-OPS and reconciled quarterly against HR organizational records. Superseded versions are retired to the Policy Archive with status "Historical - Do Not Use" and immutable retention metadata.

Contact and Escalation Matrix

Routine inquiries and classification workflow support requests should be directed to DG-OPS via the Governance Service Portal (Request Category: Data Classification; Queue: GSV-DGOPS; Reference Prefix: GSV-DC-). For escalations related to policy interpretation, contact the DGC Secretariat (Ticket Prefix: DGC-SCRT) citing the applicable section reference and the affected data domain. Incidents involving suspected mislabeling or handling deviations must be recorded as governance issues in ServiceNow (Issue Type: Governance - Data Classification) and routed to the relevant steward group. Target response times adhere to published SLAs, with priority assignment based on business impact and data classification level. After-hours coverage is coordinated through the Enterprise Operations Center, which will engage the on-call steward according to the monthly rota (Roster ID: DG-OPS-ROTA-2026-07).

Closing Statement

Meridian Capital reaffirms its commitment to proportionate, consistent, and transparent data governance. This policy, supported by robust operational controls, quantified metrics, and documented accountability, remains the authoritative reference for classification and handling across the enterprise. All teams are expected to maintain continuous adherence and to participate in scheduled reviews to ensure ongoing fitness for purpose and alignment with regulatory expectations and business needs.